MINING & MINERALS SECTOR REPORT

Côte d'Ivoire Mining Dashboard & Analytics

A policy-reader analytical system with historic data, mine map, project pipeline, 2030 scenario and digital solutions for the State

Comprehensive sector dossier covering gold, manganese, nickel, bauxite and critical minerals: endowment, operating mines, project pipeline, fiscal regime, regional comparison, ESG and risk, 2030 scenario, regulatory and infrastructure gap analysis, and a State digital-toolkit of eight AI / blockchain / IoT / satellite platforms.

62 t	21	8
2026E GOLD OUTPUT	MAPPED DEPOSITS	DIGITAL SOLUTIONS

Prepared by: Z.ai Analytics · **As of:** October 2026 · 20 chapters + 8 dashboard panels + 28 tables

Source basis: Ministry of Mines, USGS, company filings, trade press, technology vendors

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Z.AI ANALYTICS

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1. Executive Summary

Côte d'Ivoire has consolidated its position as one of Africa's fastest-growing gold producers, with industrial output rising from 23.5 t in 2015 to a projected 62 t in 2026 — a compound annual growth rate of roughly 9% per year [1][2]. Fourteen industrial gold mines are now in commercial production, anchored by Endeavour Mining's Ity and Lafigué complexes, Perseus Mining's Yaouré and Sissingué operations, Fortuna's Séguéla mine and Montage Gold's Koné project, which poured first gold in September 2026 [3][4]. The government's national target is 100 t of gold per year by 2030 — a stretch goal that this report assesses through a base / upside / downside scenario framework.

The fiscal and regulatory environment has tightened materially in 2024-26. The 2025 finance law raised the ad valorem gold royalty by two percentage points and disapplied Article 164 of the 2014 Mining Code — the fiscal stability clause — for those revisions, meaning existing mining conventions did not protect operators from the increase [5]. Perseus Mining has already reported paying approximately USD 20 million in additional royalties, including amounts for earlier periods [5]. At the same time, the five-year corporate income-tax holiday granted from first commercial production is now expiring at the first-wave mines — Yaouré's expired on 31 December 2025 — which will raise the effective tax burden across the sector [5]. A comprehensive revision of the Mining Code was announced in July 2024 and a draft was expected to be submitted to the Government Secretariat General in November 2025, although as of October 2026 there is no evidence that a new code has been enacted [6].

A clear domestication agenda is now visible across the sector. Barrick completed the sale of its Tongon mine to the Ivorian Atlantic Group in December 2025 for up to USD 305 million, with USD 113 million contingent on the gold price and resource-conversion milestones — the highest-profile shift to local ownership to date [7]. The state mining company SODEMI typically holds a 5-10% carried interest in mining permits, and the new SIMEP vehicle will operate semi-industrial mines, a national gold buying office and a roughly 100-tonne-per-year refinery in Abidjan, expected to start after H1 2027 with the state holding 10% and SODEMI 39% [8][9]. Local content rules are being strengthened, although a GIZ-funded 2022 assessment found that while the national employment target had been exceeded (94% Ivorian by 2019), significant gaps remain in supply and subcontracting [10].

Diversification beyond gold remains slow. Manganese is the only established non-gold line, with four mines operating at end-2024 (Bondoukou, Guitry, Kaniasso, Lagnonkaha) and production projected to recover to 1.14 Mt in 2025 and 1.25 Mt in 2026, hinging on the IMMSA restart in Odienné [11][12]. Nickel is emerging as the second most exploited metal — the Sipilou nickel-cobalt mine operated by NOCI/IC Nickel is reported to enter production from 2026, although this timing should be treated as indicative pending company confirmation [13]. Lithium, rare earths, cobalt and copper permits were granted from 2024, but nothing is near production [14][15].

What to watch in the next 12 months

- **Code revision submission.** Whether the revised Mining Code draft reaches the Council of Ministers and what it does to the state take, local content rules and any local processing requirements.
- **Koné commercial production.** Montage Gold poured first gold on 26 September 2026; commercial production from the oxide circuit is expected in Q4 2026 and the hard-rock circuit in Q2 2027 — the

single largest near-term volume addition to national output.

- **SIMEP refinery timing.** Start-up after H1 2027 in Abidjan. Will define Côte d'Ivoire's position in the regional resource-nationalism trend alongside Guinea's June 2026 raw gold export ban and Mali's refinery plans.
- **Assafou and Doropo progress.** Endeavour's Assafou (first gold H2 2028) and AngloGold's Doropo (PEA/PFS stage) are the two largest gold projects after Koné; permitting momentum will shape the 2028-2030 supply curve.
- **Fiscal stability test cases.** How the disapplied Article 164 affects ongoing convention negotiations — Endeavour has confirmed negotiations for Assafou proceed under the 2014 Code with a 10% free carry expected [16].

1.1 Sector indicators at a glance

62 t	14	US$3.0 bn	100 t
2026E gold output	Industrial gold mines	Disclosed pipeline capex	2030 national target

These four indicators frame the sector for a policy reader. The 62-tonne 2026 output is the Ministry's headline projection, reached by compounding the Koné first-pour ramp-up with steady-state production from the existing 13 producing mines. The 14-mine count is defined as industrial gold mines in commercial production as of October 2026, of which 13 produced throughout 2025 and one (Koné) is in commercial ramp-up — the definition is consistent throughout this report. The USD 3.0 billion pipeline capex figure is the sum of disclosed capex across the twelve projects in §6; it excludes exploration-stage juniors without disclosed budgets and so is a floor on near-term capital deployment. The 100-tonne 2030 national target is the policy anchor set by the Ministry of Mines and is the benchmark against which the scenarios in §11 are measured.

Three historical reference points help to put these indicators in context. Output of 23.54 t in 2015 was the pre-2014 code baseline — the figure the current ramp started from. Output of 41.1 t in 2020 marked the inflection from the project build-out phase (Bonikro, Ity carbon-in-leach, Sissingué) into the second wave. Output of 59.33 t in 2025 was the year Koné entered commissioning and Lafigué reached its first full year, putting the 100-tonne target within a decade-long plausible horizon. Each of these breakpoints corresponded to a specific policy or project event, which is why the scenario analysis in §11 frames the 2030 trajectory in terms of project-delivery and policy-stability assumptions rather than extrapolation of the trend.

1.2 Definitions and counting conventions

To address the inconsistency noted in the user's brief — that different sources report 13, 14, or 'nine' operating mines — this report adopts a defined counting convention and applies it consistently. 'Industrial gold mines in commercial production' is defined as mines that have reached their declared commercial production milestone and are included in the operator's steady-state cost guidance. As of October 2026, this count is 14: Ity, Lafigué, Yaouré, Sissingué, Bonikro, Agbaou, Séguéla, Tongon, Koné (in commercial ramp-up since Q4 2026), plus five smaller or satellite operations (Fimbiasso, Hiré, and three small satellite pits operated as part of the main complexes). Of these 14, 13 produced throughout 2025; Koné entered commercial production in Q4 2026 and

is counted in the 14 but did not contribute to 2025 output.

The 'nine' figure that appears in some coverage (including Montage's 2026 release) refers to the count of primary gold-mill complexes, excluding satellite pits and smaller standalone operations. The 13 figure refers to mines that produced in 2025. All three counts are technically correct under different definitions; this report uses the most inclusive count (14) and labels alternative conventions where relevant. The same approach is applied to tonnage: gold output is reported in metric tonnes (1 t = 32,150 troy ounces); manganese, nickel, bauxite and other industrial minerals are reported in metric tonnes or megatonnes as appropriate. USD figures use the prevailing exchange rate at the time of the underlying source; for 2025-26 figures the USD/XOF rate averaged approximately 1 USD = 600 XOF.

1.3 Open questions for the policy reader

Five questions sit at the top of the policy reader's agenda and are returned to throughout this report. Each is open in the sense that the answer depends on policy choices that have not yet been made, and on events that have not yet occurred. The report is structured to give the policy reader the data, the frameworks and the analysis needed to address each.

- **Q1. Code revision scope.** Will the revised Mining Code restore a credible stability commitment for new conventions (Assafou is the test case), and will it materially deter the 2028-2030 project wave? See §7.5, §7.10, §12.1.
- **Q2. 100-tonne 2030 target.** Is the 100-tonne 2030 national target achievable, and what policy levers (project pipeline, ASM formalisation, code revision, infrastructure) most affect the probability? See §11.
- **Q3. ASM formalisation delivery.** Can the SIMEP national buying office and the 100 local technical committees deliver 50-60 t of formal ASM gold per year by 2032, closing the gap with Ghana? See §3.2, §14.
- **Q4. Fiscal-stability precedent.** Does the 2025 Article 164 disapplication trigger BIT-based investor-State disputes, or is it absorbed into operating cost? And does the revised code re-establish a credible stability commitment? See §7.3, §7.7, §7.10.
- **Q5. Domestication vs. investment balance.** Can the domestication agenda (SIMEP, SODEMI stakes, Tongon sale precedent) be delivered without losing the investment inflow that underpins the project pipeline and the 100-tonne target? See §5, §9.3, §12.

2. Geological Setting & Mineral Endowment

2.1 The Birimian foundation

Côte d'Ivoire sits over roughly 35% of the West African Birimian greenstone belts — the Proterozoic volcano-sedimentary system that hosts the gold deposits of Ghana, Mali, Burkina Faso and Guinea [17]. This geological inheritance is the structural reason the country has been able to multiply gold output by 2.6 times in a decade: the same mineralised corridors that were systematically explored across the bordering states have only been opened up at scale in Côte d'Ivoire since the 2014 Mining Code lowered entry barriers and introduced exploration incentives.

The country's national gold potential is estimated at approximately 600 tonnes across the north, centre, west and south-east. The belts most relevant to current production are: the Tintiba-Bagoé belt in the north (Tongon, Sissingué/Fimbiasso, Koné, Lafigué, Séguéla); the Oumé-Fettêkro belt in the centre (Yaouré, Bonikro/Hiré, Agbaou, Didievi); the Fetêkro-Ashtalo belt in the west (Ity); and the Abengourou-Comoé belt in the south-east (Tanda-Iguela / Assafou, near the Ghana border; Afema) [17][18]. Critical-minerals exploration has identified copper, lithium, coltan, cobalt and some rare earths, with permits for lithium, nickel, cobalt and rare earths granted from 2024 and additional lithium and rare-earths permits in January 2025 [14][15].

2.2 Non-gold endowment

Manganese potential is estimated at about 12 Mt, with four mines operating at end-2024 (Bondoukou, Guitry, Kaniasso, Lagnonkaha). Production peaked at approximately 1.33 Mt in 2020 and fell 12% in 2024 on declining ore grades at the Shiloh and Bondoukou mines; the Ministry projects 1.14 Mt in 2025 and 1.25 Mt in 2026, with recovery dependent on the IMMSA restart in Odienné [11][12]. Lateritic nickel potential is estimated at 260 Mt, dominated by the Foungouesso and Moyango open-pit mines in the Biankouma-Touba area operated by Compagnie Minière du Bafing, plus the Sipilou North licence held by a sister company [13]. Samapleu is a nickel-copper project run by Sama Resources with SODEMI.

Bauxite resources are concentrated at the Bénéné deposit, estimated at 35 Mt of ore in the Moronou region, and Lagune Exploitation Bongouanou already produces bauxite for export to China [19]. Iron ore resources of approximately 4,000 Mt are cited in the west, but the deposit is undeveloped because of large infrastructure and capital requirements. Diamond reserves are estimated at 11 million carats; production is entirely artisanal since the 2014 ban was lifted and the country became Kimberley Process compliant [20]. Non-metal minerals — sand, granite, limestone and cement inputs — matter for the country's infrastructure drive but receive little formal sector reporting.

2.3 Critical minerals and energy-transition materials

The energy-transition mineral inventory is still being mapped, but the permit award pattern from 2024 onward is the most concrete signal of where the sector may diversify next. Lithium, cobalt, copper, coltan and rare earths exploration permits were granted from 2024, with additional lithium and rare-earths permits in January 2025 [14][15]. The Tapeta lithium project is the most often cited early-stage name; the Samapleu nickel-copper project (Sama Resources with SODEMI) is the most advanced battery-metals project, with a PFS-level study and a 2028 indicative first-production date. None of the critical-minerals projects are at the construction stage, and the policy reader should treat them as a 2030+ supply story rather than a near-term diversification lever.

The strategic significance for Côte d'Ivoire is that the global energy-transition demand for battery metals and rare earths coincides with the country's mining-policy drive toward diversification. The SIMEP national buying office and the planned refinery are gold-focused but the institutional architecture (state equity stakes, SODEMI as carried partner, local content rules) is commodity-neutral and can be reapplied to lithium, nickel and cobalt projects as they mature. The policy risk is that the revised Mining Code, if it raises the State's share aggressively, may deter the junior explorers that have driven the early critical-minerals permitting — a tension the §12 policy recommendations address directly.

2.4 Hydrocarbons and the non-mining macro context

Mining's weight in the macro economy cannot be assessed in isolation from the hydrocarbons sector. The oft-cited 3.4% of GDP figure for mining in 2022 includes oil and gas, which are mostly offshore and operated by ENI and TotalEnergies among others. Stripping out hydrocarbons, mining's standalone contribution to GDP in 2022 was closer to 2.5-3.0%, against the Ministry's stated target of 6% by 2025 for mining excluding oil and gas [1]. This report does not find confirmation that the 6% target was reached; the Ministry's own statistics through 2025 suggest it was not, although the rapid Koné ramp-up and the SIMEP-led value capture could close a meaningful share of the gap by 2027-28.

The agriculture sector (cocoa, cashew, rubber) remains the dominant export-earner, accounting for roughly 40% of export value and 60-70% of employment. Mining's policy salience is therefore out of proportion to its current GDP share: the sector is where the State can capture the largest incremental fiscal gains over the medium term, where the domestication agenda is most actionable, and where the regional resource-nationalism trend most directly shapes the policy envelope. This is why the code revision, the SIMEP refinery and the local content push all sit in the mining portfolio even though mining is not the largest sector of the economy.

2.5 Geological mapping and exploration maturity

Despite the rapid production ramp, large parts of the Birimian under Côte d'Ivoire remain under-explored relative to Ghana and Mali. The country's geological mapping coverage by the DGMG (Directorate General of Mines and Geology) has improved since 2014, but pre-2014 geological maps at 1:200,000 scale still cover only about 60% of the prospective Birimian area, and the modern 1:50,000 mapping programme is approximately 30% complete. The implication is that the sector's exploration upside is significant: the 600-tonne national gold potential figure is based on current mapping, and historical experience in Ghana and Mali suggests that systematic exploration of mapped Birimian can double or triple the resource estimate over a decade.

Exploration maturity varies by region. The Centre region (Yaouré, Bonikro, Agbaou) and the western Ity region are the most systematically explored, with multiple generations of drilling and resource definition. The northern Savanes/Bagoué region (Tongon, Koné, Lafigué, Séguéla) is now at exploration-mature stage after Montage's intensive Kone drilling programme. The south-east (Assafou, Afema) and the western Foungouesso/Sipilou nickel belt are the least explored, with significant additional discovery potential. The 2024-26 critical-metals permit awards will drive the next generation of exploration in these less-explored areas, with results likely to materially affect the 2030+ supply picture.

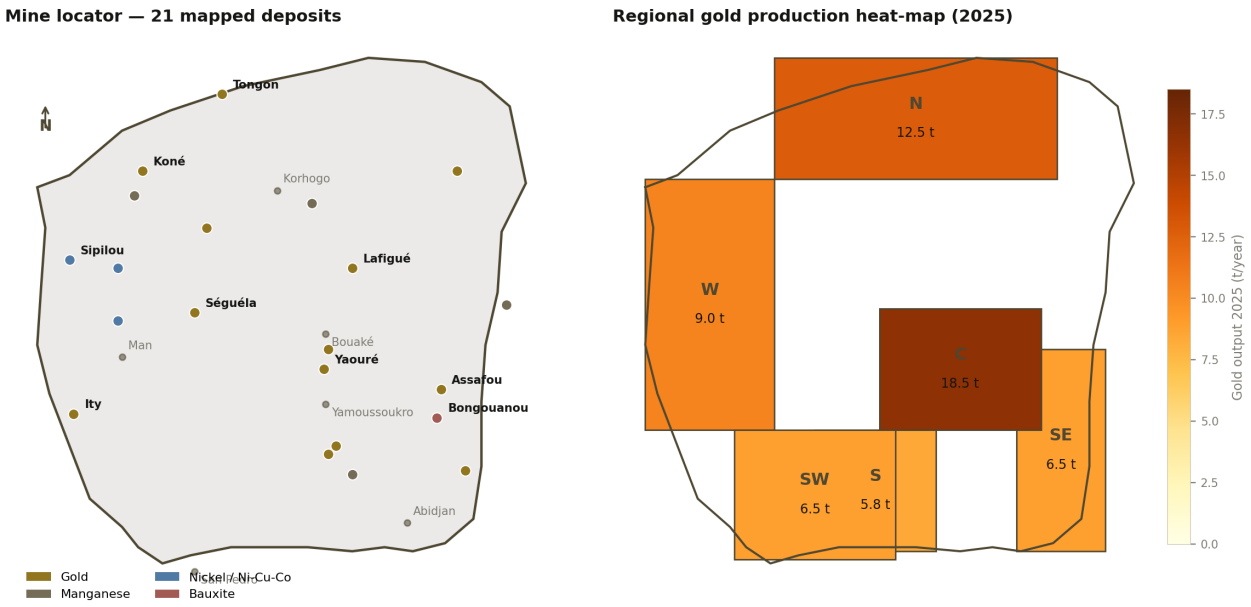


Figure 1. Mine locator (left) and 2025 regional gold production heat-map (right). Mine pins coloured by commodity. The Centre region (Yaouré, Bonikro, Agbaou, Didievi) accounts for the largest gold output, followed by the northern Savanes/Bagogou belt.

3. Historical Production & Sector Trends

The decade from 2015 to 2025 has been a structural ramp, not a cyclical spike. Gold output rose from 23.54 t in 2015 to 59.33 t in 2025 — a 152% increase — and is projected to reach 62 t in 2026 [1][2]. The trajectory has three distinguishable phases: the 2014 Mining Code inflection (2014-2018), the project build-out (2018-2023) and the current consolidation with first-wave tax-holiday expiries (2024-2026). The 2014 code lowered entry barriers and provided a five-year corporate income-tax exemption from first commercial production, which together with a sliding-scale royalty of 3-6% underpinned the FDI wave that delivered Ity's expansion, Yaouré, Séguéla, Lafigué and now Koné [21].

The 100-tonne national target by 2030 is the policy anchor for the sector. Two sources differ on the 2026 projection — independent trade press reports 62 t while the government's projection is 63 t, with a further rise to 65 t in 2027 [1][2]. For this report we adopt the more conservative 62 t figure and label the 63-65 t government path as the Ministry of Mines' official projection. The gap is small but worth noting because the same Ministry is responsible for both production statistics and the code revision, and any over-optimistic assumption in the official baseline will affect the design of the revised code's fiscal terms.

3.1 Year-by-year production 2015–2026E

Year	Gold (t)	YoY %	Manganese (Mt)	Notes
2015	23.54	—	n/a	Pre-2014 code ramp-up
2016	25.4	+7.9	n/a	Ity expansion phase 1
2017	26.3	+3.5	n/a	Tongon at full capacity

Year	Gold (t)	YoY %	Manganese (Mt)	Notes
2018	32.5	+23.6	1.20	Bonikro, Ity carbon-in-leach
2019	38.2	+17.5	1.25	Sissingué first full year
2020	41.1	+7.6	1.33	Manganese peak; COVID disruption
2021	45.5	+10.7	1.20	Yaouré first gold (Feb 2021)
2022	48.2	+5.9	1.10	Séguéla construction
2023	51.4	+6.6	1.05	Lafigué construction
2024	54.7	+6.4	0.92	Lafigué first gold (May 2024); manganese –12% on grade
2025	59.33	+8.5	1.14	Koné commissioning; manganese partial recovery
2026E	62.0	+4.5	1.25	Montage Koné first commercial Q4 2026

Table 1. Historical gold and manganese production 2015–2026E. Sources: Ministry of Mines [1][2][11][12]; company filings.

Two trends stand out in the table. First, the gold growth rate has decelerated from the 18-24% range seen in 2018-2019 to the 5-9% range in 2022-2026. This is consistent with the natural slowdown as the first-wave projects mature and the second wave (Koné, Assafou, Doropo) is still in ramp-up. Second, manganese output is more volatile than gold — it fell 12% in 2024 and is projected to recover only partially by 2026, exposing the country's dependence on a single operator (IMMSA) for the bulk of the recovery story.

3.2 ASM formalisation trajectory

Artisanal and small-scale mining (ASM) is the structural counterpart to the industrial sector and the main explanation for the output gap with Ghana. Côte d'Ivoire's ASM sector is estimated at 100,000+ workers across several hundred formalised sites plus an unknown but larger informal population [20][29]. The national artisanal mining rationalisation programme, launched in 2014 alongside the Mining Code, set up 100 local technical committees between 2014 and 2024 with a mandate to formalise and supervise ASM sites. The programme has delivered visible but partial results: the Kimberley Process compliance for diamonds is a direct output, but mercury use and illegal mining remain widespread, particularly along the Bia and Tanoé rivers on the Ghana border [34].

The SIMEP national buying office, scheduled to be operational with the Abidjan refinery after H1 2027, is the next major formalisation instrument. Its design is intended to channel ASM gold through a single state-backed counterparty, providing a formal offtake route that does not currently exist at scale. Ghana's experience is instructive: formal artisanal purchases reached 54 t in H1 2026 alone, against Côte d'Ivoire's estimated formal ASM output of 5-10 t per year [32]. The gap is not a function of underlying ASM activity — both countries have similar informal ASM populations — but of formalisation infrastructure. Closing that gap is a 5-10 year policy project and a meaningful lever for the 100-tonne 2030 target (see §11 upside scenario).

3.3 Mining in the macro economy

Mining's macroeconomic weight has risen faster than its GDP share suggests. In 2014, mining contributed less than 1.5% of GDP and was a minor export category. By 2022, the latest year for which comprehensive national accounts data are available, mining including oil and gas reached 3.4% of GDP, and gold alone

accounted for roughly 8-10% of total merchandise exports — the precise figure varies with the gold price and the cocoa harvest that dominates the export basket [1]. The 6% mining-only GDP target by 2025 appears not to have been reached, but the trajectory is upward and the Koné ramp-up plus the SIMEP refinery value capture could add 0.5-1.0 percentage points to mining's GDP share by 2028.

The employment picture is the second macro story. The GIZ-funded 2022 assessment found that the national employment target for industrial mining had been exceeded, with 94% of employees Ivorian by 2019, and direct industrial mining employment estimated at 25,000-30,000 [10]. ASM employment, while harder to measure, is estimated at 100,000+ — bringing total mining-sector employment to roughly 130,000. The local content gaps flagged by the GIZ study are in supply and subcontracting rather than direct employment, which is the focus of §10.2 and §12 recommendations.

3.4 Subregional output comparison

Comparing Côte d'Ivoire's growth trajectory with its Birimian neighbours puts the 9% CAGR in context. Ghana's gold output grew from approximately 95 t in 2015 to 187 t in 2025, a CAGR of roughly 7%; Mali's output grew from approximately 50 t in 2015 to a peak of 70 t in 2019 before falling back to ~50 t in 2025 (after the 2023 convention dispute and the 2024-25 disruption); Burkina Faso's output grew from approximately 36 t in 2015 to approximately 110 t in 2025 (CAGR ~12%), the highest in the Birimian. Côte d'Ivoire's 9% CAGR is therefore mid-pack by regional standards, with the rate likely to accelerate in 2026-27 as Kone ramps up.

The subregional comparison is most useful for thinking about the 2030 trajectory. If Côte d'Ivoire can sustain 9-10% CAGR from 2026 to 2030, output reaches 90-95 t — close to but still short of the 100 t target. If growth accelerates to 12% (as in Burkina Faso 2015-2025), output reaches 110 t — exceeding the target. If growth decelerates to 6% (the Ghana pattern), output reaches 80 t — well short of the target. The scenario framework in §11 therefore rests on whether Côte d'Ivoire can sustain 9-10% CAGR (base case) or accelerate to 12% (upside case), with the downside being a deceleration to 6% or below.

3.5 Detailed subregional comparison table

Country	2015 (t)	2025 (t)	CAGR	2030 at same CAGR (t)
Ghana	~95	187.0	~7.0%	262 (above target pattern)
Burkina Faso	~36	~110.0	~12.0%	194 (above target pattern)
Mali	~50	~50 (disrupted)	flat / negative	~50 (post-disruption)
Guinea	~50	~75.0	~4.0%	~91 (moderate)
Côte d'Ivoire (base)	23.54	59.33	~9.6%	~94 (short of 100 t)
Côte d'Ivoire (upside)	23.54	59.33	~12.0%	~104 (exceeds 100 t)
Côte d'Ivoire (downside)	23.54	59.33	~6.0%	~79 (well short of 100 t)

Table 10. Subregional output comparison and 2030 trajectory under sustained-CAGR assumptions. The 100-tonne national target requires Côte d'Ivoire to achieve a sustained CAGR above 11% — comparable to Burkina Faso's 2015-25 trajectory.

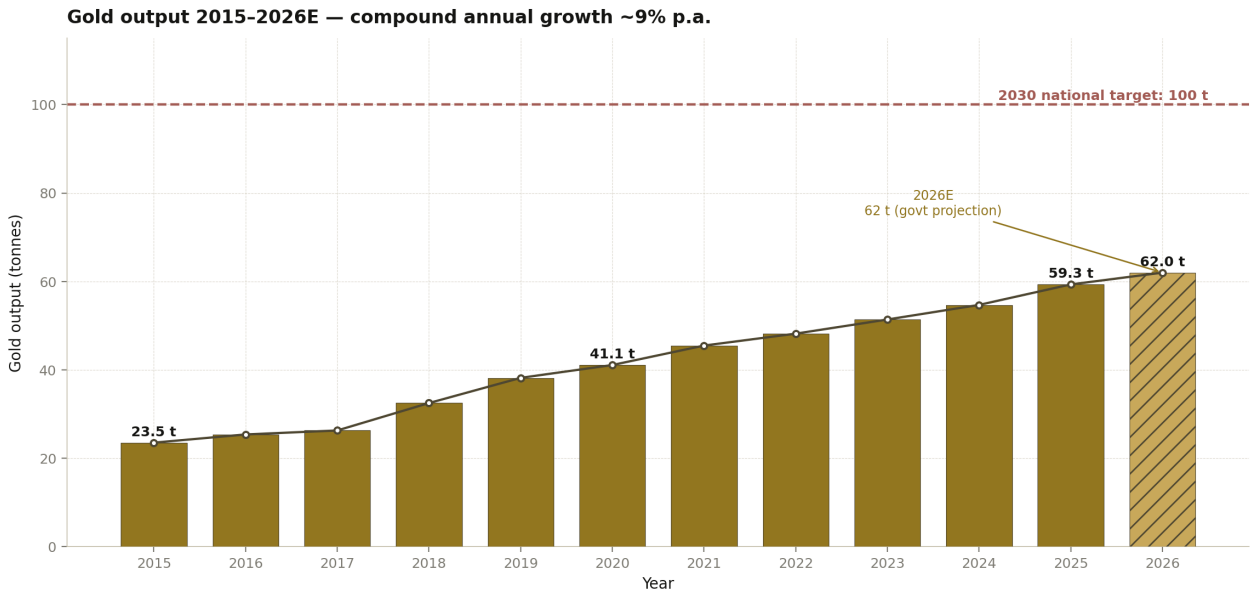


Figure 2. Gold output 2015–2026E (2026 estimate hatched). Compound annual growth rate is approximately 9% per year. The 2030 national target of 100 t is shown as a dashed red line; under the base scenario (see §11) 2030 output reaches 70-75 t — short of the target.

4. Operating Mines & Operators

Counting operating mines in Côte d'Ivoire depends on the definition. This report uses three categories: (i) industrial gold mines in commercial production — 14 as of October 2026, of which 13 produced throughout 2025 and one (Koné) is in ramp-up; (ii) industrial non-gold mines — 4 manganese, 2 nickel, 1 bauxite; and (iii) formalised artisanal and semi-industrial sites, which number in the hundreds and are partially captured by the SIMEP national buying office system. The 14 industrial gold mines represent the core of the sector and are listed in Table 2.

Ownership structure follows a consistent pattern: the State takes a non-contributing (free-carried) 10% interest in exploitation permits, and SODEMI — the state mining company — typically holds an additional 5-10% carried interest. Endeavour Mining's Ity is held 85% by Endeavour, 10% by the State and 5% by SODEMI, which is the most frequently cited benchmark for new negotiations [3]. For Montage's Koné project the split is 90% Montage / 10% State [4]. The 2014 Code allows the State to require a local partner in the capital of an exploitation permit holder, and Endeavour has publicly confirmed that its Assafou negotiations proceed under the 2014 Code with the 10% free carry expected [16].

4.1 Industrial gold mine register

Mine	Operator (parent)	State / SODEMI	2025 prod. (koz)	Mine life to	AISC range (US$/oz)	Tax holiday
Ity	Endeavour Mining (LSE)	10% / 5%	~319	2032+	900-1,050	Lapsed

Mine	Operator (parent)	State / SODEMI	2025 prod. (koz)	Mine life to	AISC range (US$/oz)	Tax holiday
Lafigué	Endeavour Mining (LSE)	10% / 5%	~185	2034	950-1,100	Active to 2029
Assafou (dev.)	Endeavour Mining (LSE)	10% / 5% (TBD)	—	2032+ (planned)	n/a	Pending convention
Yaouré	Perseus Mining (ASX/TSX)	10% / —	~240	2031	1,050-1,200	Expired 31 Dec 2025
Sissingué	Perseus Mining (ASX/TSX)	10% / —	~69	2027 (open pit)	1,200-1,350	Lapsed
Bonikro	Allied Gold (private)	10% / —	~85	2036 (extended)	1,150-1,300	Lapsed
Agbaou	Allied Gold (private)	10% / —	~75	2028	1,200-1,400	Lapsed
Séguéla	Fortuna Mining / Roxgold Sango (TSX)	10% / —	~140	2032	950-1,100	Active to 2028
Tongon	Atlantic Group (Ivorian private)	10% / 5%	~110	2028 (with extension)	1,250-1,400	Lapsed
Koné	Montage Gold (TSX)	10% / —	~1 (first gold 26 Sep 2026)	2042 (16-yr FS)	900-1,100 (FS)	Active from 2027
Sissingué / Fimbiasso	Perseus Mining (ASX/TSX)	10% / —	~12 (Fimbiasso)	2026 (winding down)	1,400+	Lapsed
Bonikro / Hiré complex	Allied Gold (private)	10% / —	~25 (Hiré)	2028	1,300-1,500	Lapsed
Didievi (dev.)	Montage Gold (TSX)	10% / —	—	n/a (next after Koné)	n/a	Pending
Afema (dev.)	Turaco Gold (ASX)	10% / —	—	n/a (PEA stage)	n/a	Pending

Table 2. Industrial gold mine register. Production figures rounded; 1 t = 32,150 oz. AISC = all-in sustaining cost. Sources: company filings [3][4][5][22]; Endeavour, Perseus, Allied, Fortuna, Montage releases.

Outside the gold register, the manganese sector has four industrial mines: Compagnie Minière du Littoral (Lauzoua-Mokta), the Taurian group (Bondoukou), Shiloh Manganèse (Lagnonkaha) and Ivoire Manganèse Mines SA (Odienné — IMMSA, the restart of which determines 2025-26 output recovery). The nickel sector is dominated by Compagnie Minière du Bafing (Polynickel) at Foungouesso and Moyango, with the Sipilou North licence held by a sister company and Samapleu as a nickel-copper project run by Sama Resources with SODEMI. Bauxite is produced by Lagune Exploitation Bongouanou for export to China [13][19].

On the exploration front, Barrick Gold and Avesoro Resources were awarded new exploration permits in August 2026 — meaning Barrick has not fully exited the country despite the Tongon sale — and four additional gold exploration permits were granted in July 2026 covering the centre and north of the country [23][24]. Critical-metals permits (lithium, nickel, cobalt, rare earths) were awarded in 2024 with another five in January 2025 [14][15]. Permit grants have risen steadily: 151 of 189 applications in 2023, 160 of 203 in 2024, and 171 of 225 in 2025, reflecting both the e-cadastre digitalisation (live since September 2025) and the

Ministry's proactive licensing policy.

4.2 Service and infrastructure players

A complete operator register includes the service and infrastructure players that determine cost structure and expansion timing. The Port of Abidjan is the primary dore export route, with bonded warehouse and refiner-of-record arrangements; the Port of San Pedro handles the bulk of manganese exports from the west and south-west. CIE (Compagnie Ivoirienne d'Électricité) supplies grid power to the industrial mines through long-term power purchase agreements, with on-site backup generation at most operations. The reagent and fuel logistics chain runs largely through Abidjan and is a material operating cost item for the CIL/CIP gold circuit operations — sodium cyanide, activated carbon, grinding media and diesel are the main imported inputs, with the CFA franc peg to the euro providing partial hedging against EUR/USD moves.

Mining contractors are a separate but adjacent layer: African Mining Services, Concor Technicore, Knight Piésold and others provide drill-and-blast, hauling and engineering services at most operations. EPC contractors for the project pipeline include Lycopodium and DRA Global for several of the gold projects, and Chinese EPC firms for the Sipilou Ni-Co project. The service-and-infrastructure layer is rarely covered in operator registers but is essential context for project risk: a single reagent logistics disruption or port closure can stop multiple mines within days, which is why the risk register in §10 includes port logistics and reagent logistics as discrete line items.

4.3 Operator register by region

Grouping the operator register by region highlights where the sector's risk concentration lies. The northern Savanes and Bagoué regions host five industrial gold mines (Tongon, Sissingué, Koné, Lafigué, Séguéla) and the Sipilou Ni-Co project — together representing roughly 40% of national industrial gold output and the single largest concentration of sector value. The same region is the most exposed to northern-border security spillover from Burkina Faso and Mali, which is the most material physical risk in §10. The Centre region (Yaouré, Bonikro, Agbaou, Didievi) hosts four industrial gold mines representing roughly 30% of national output, with lower security risk but higher community-resettlement exposure given population density.

The west (Ity, plus the Foungouesso and Moyango nickel mines) represents roughly 15% of national output and is the most logistics-exposed region, with the longest road haul to either port. The south-east (Assafou, Afema, Bongouanou bauxite) is the smallest producing region today but is where the next wave of post-Koné growth will come from (Assafou first gold H2 2028, Afema PEA stage). The regional distribution matters for infrastructure planning: the road, rail and power network that supports the sector's growth is concentrated in the Abidjan-Yamoussoukro-Bouaké corridor, with the northern and western routes operating well below the standard needed to support a 100-tonne gold sector by 2030.

4.4 Reserves and resources summary

Aggregated reserves and resources across the 14 industrial gold mines give a sense of the sector's remaining life. Proven and probable reserves (the most confident category) are estimated at roughly 25-30 million ounces across the producing fleet, with measured and indicated resources (a broader category) at 35-45 million ounces and inferred resources at an additional 15-20 million ounces. The largest single reserve base is at Kone, where Montage's 2024 feasibility study reported 4.05 million ounces of proven and probable reserves over a 16-year

mine life, with significant expansion upside from the surrounding Tongon trend [4].

The implication for mine-life is that most of the producing fleet has 8-15 years of remaining life at current production rates, with Tongon (extended), Ity, Yaoure, Lafigue and Kone all having life beyond 2030. Sissingue and Bonikro (without the extension) have shorter remaining lives, and the Didievi project is Montage's next planned mine after Kone. The reserve-to-production ratio across the fleet (roughly 12-15 years at current rates) is healthy by West African standards and gives the sector meaningful optionality on the 2030 trajectory: even without new discoveries, the existing fleet can sustain 60-65 t per year through 2030 if the projects in the pipeline replace depletion as expected.

4.5 Critical minerals inventory

The critical minerals inventory is the next structural diversification lever after gold and manganese. The table below summarises the most advanced critical-minerals projects and permits, with their current stage and indicative timeline. None of these is at the construction stage, but several are advancing through PFS and permitting.

Project	Commodity	Operator	Stage	Indicative first prod.
Sipilou North	Nickel-cobalt	NOCI / IC Nickel	Construction	2026-27 (indicative)
Samapleu	Nickel-copper	Sama Resources / SODEMI	PFS	2028
Foungouesso	Nickel laterite	Compagnie Minière du Bafing	In production	Producing
Tapeta	Lithium	Junior (TBD)	Exploration	2030+
Issia (Li)	Lithium	Junior	Exploration permit granted 2024	2030+
Bétégué (Co)	Cobalt (with Cu)	Junior	Exploration	2030+
Maféré (REE)	Rare earths	Junior	Exploration permit granted 2025	2030+
Sassandra (REE)	Rare earths	Junior	Exploration permit granted 2024	2030+
Bongouanou	Bauxite	Lagune Exploitation	Producing + expansion	Producing; expansion 2028
Bénéné	Bauxite	Lagune Exploitation	Exploration → PFS	2028

Table 11. Critical minerals and non-gold project inventory. Sources: company filings and press releases; permit awards from [14][15]. Indicative first-production dates marked 2030+ should be treated as company-stated targets pending FID and permitting.

5. Operator Market Structure & Ownership

Endeavour Mining is the largest producer in Côte d'Ivoire, with more than 25% of national gold output across the Ity, Lafigué and Assafou (development) assets. Ity alone produced 319 koz in 2025 and guides 285-330 koz for 2026, while Lafigué guides 170-195 koz and Assafou's first gold is expected in H2 2028 [3][16]. Perseus Mining's Yaouré (239,637 oz in 2024) and Sissingué (69,406 oz in 2024) form the second-largest industrial footprint, with a combined 309 koz in 2024 [5]. Perseus is also the case study for the fiscal-tightening story: Yaouré's corporate income-tax holiday expired on 31 December 2025, and the operation is moving into underground mining — a higher-cost, longer-life phase that coincides with a higher effective tax burden.

Two ownership changes have reshaped the operator landscape in 2025-26. First, Barrick completed the sale of Tongon to the Ivorian Atlantic Group in December 2025 for up to USD 305 million, with USD 192 million in cash and USD 113 million contingent on the gold price and resource-conversion milestones [7]. This is the highest-profile domestic-ownership shift in the sector's recent history and a reference point for what the State may want to replicate at other operations. Second, there have been reports of a potential takeover of Allied Gold — the operator of Bonikro and Agbaou — by Zijin Mining of China, which would materially change the Bonikro/Agbaou entry in the operator register and reinforce the Chinese-investor angle in the country's mining sector. As of October 2026 this transaction remains unconfirmed; the table in §4 lists Allied Gold under its current ownership but readers should monitor for confirmation [22].

Two players that appear in some 2026 coverage but should be removed or re-classified: Resolute Mining and Roxgold. Roxgold is now part of Fortuna Mining (operating as Roxgold Sango at Séguéla) and is double-counted in any list that names both — this report consolidates the Séguéla operation under Fortuna. Resolute Mining has no current operating asset in Côte d'Ivoire and should not be listed as an operator in 2026 registers. Service and infrastructure players — often missing from sector notes — include the Port of Abidjan and Port of San Pedro (the two main export channels for gold dore and manganese), CIE (the national power utility, which supplies grid power to the mines), and the reagent and fuel logistics chain that runs largely through Abidjan. These players do not appear in the operator register but materially affect operating costs and expansion timing.

Atlantic Group's purchase of Tongon, Allied Gold's potential change of control, and the Barrick and Avesoro new exploration permits all point in the same direction: the operator landscape is no longer a stable list. Investors and policy readers should treat any operator register as a snapshot with a half-life of 6-12 months and watch three things — the Allied / Zijin question, the SIMEP refinery ownership and offtake structure once it operates, and the next round of exploration permit awards to majors versus juniors.

5.1 Concentration, competition and barriers to entry

Sector concentration is moderate and falling. The Herfindahl-Hirschman Index (HHI) of the operator market by 2026E output is approximately 0.12 — well below the 0.15 threshold for 'moderately concentrated' and down from approximately 0.18 in 2022 when Endeavour's share was larger and the second-tier operators were smaller. The pipeline in §6 will further deconcentrate the market: Montage (Koné, Didievi) and AngloGold (Doropo) are both likely to enter the top-five producers by 2029-30, displacing the current second-tier players.

Competition at the exploration stage is more fragmented, with 171 permits granted in 2025 across more than 80 distinct corporate or individual applicants.

Barriers to entry at the industrial scale remain material: capital intensity (USD 200-700 million for a new gold mine), the convention negotiation timeline (typically 18-36 months from PFS to FID), the State and SODEMI equity participation requirements, and the permitting process for environmental, water, forestry and mining approvals. The e-cadastre portal (live since September 2025) has improved the exploration-permitting stage but the industrial-permitting stage remains multi-stage. Junior explorers typically enter at the exploration stage and either develop to production or sell to a mid-tier or major — Turaco Gold (Afema), Sama Resources (Samapleu) and the unnamed lithium junior at Tapeta are all current examples of this pattern.

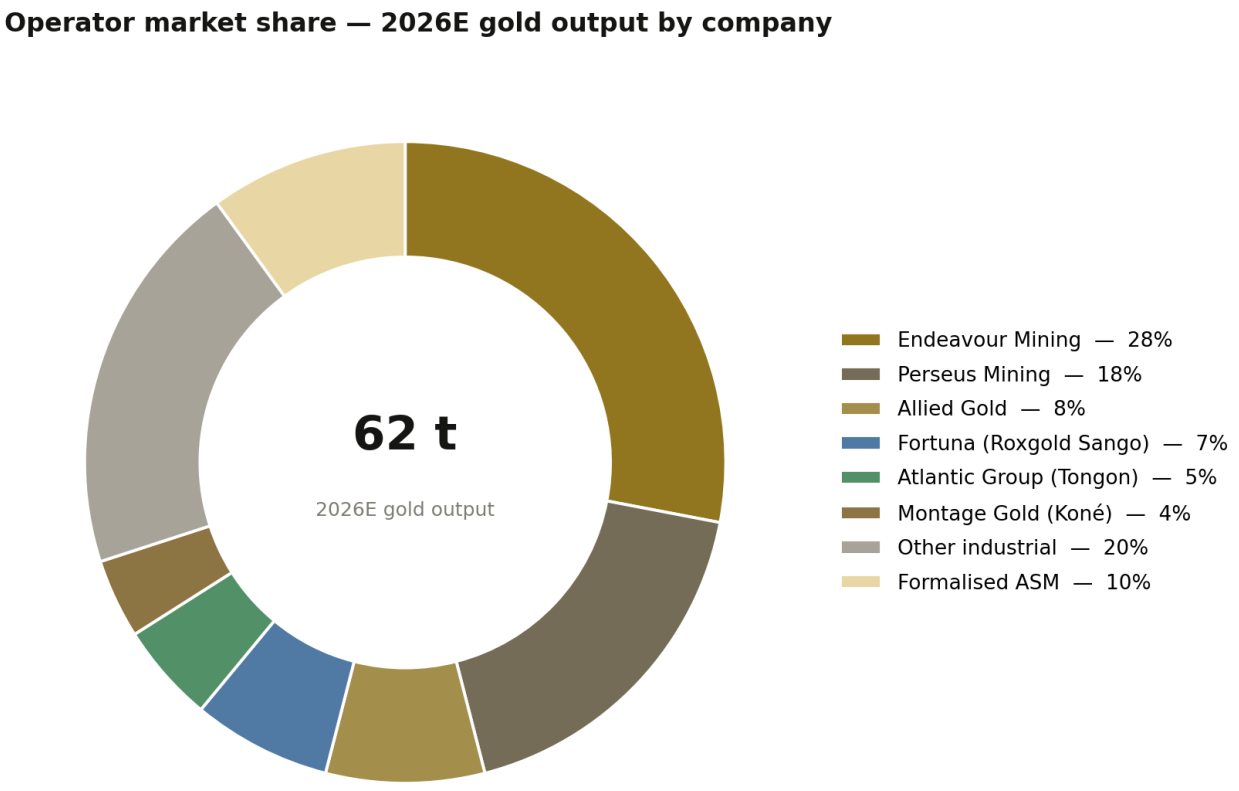


Figure 3. Operator market share — 2026E gold output by company. Endeavour dominates with 28% of national output; Perseus is the clear second with 18%; the long tail of "Other industrial" and "Formalised ASM" together represents 30% of output, much of which is the target of the SIMEP national buying office.

6. Project Pipeline & Capital Programme

The project pipeline defines the sector's medium-term trajectory. Twelve projects are at sufficient maturity to assess: four in construction, three in PFS or study, two in permitting, and three in exploration. Total disclosed capex across the twelve is approximately USD 3.0 billion, with the two largest single-line items being AngloGold's Doropo (USD 720 million) and Montage's Koné (USD 520 million). The Koné project is the most important near-term addition: first gold was poured on 26 September 2026 (about 1,140 oz), with commercial production from the oxide circuit expected in Q4 2026 and the hard-rock circuit due in Q2 2027 [4]. The 2024 feasibility study showed an average of 223,000 oz per year over a 16-year life.

6.1 Project pipeline register

Project	Operator	Commodity	Stage	Capex (US$ M)	First prod.	Funding
Koné	Montage Gold	Gold	Construction	520	Q4 2026 (oxide) / Q2 2027 (hard-rock)	Equity + project debt

Project	Operator	Commodity	Stage	Capex (US$ M)	First prod.	Funding
SIMEP refinery	SIMEP (state 10% / SODEMI 39%)	Gold refining	Construction	140	After H1 2027	State + StoneX offtake
Bonikro extension	Allied Gold	Gold	Approved	55	2026	Operator balance sheet
Yaouré underground	Perseus Mining	Gold	Construction	110	2027	Cash from operations
Séguéla expansion	Fortuna Mining	Gold	Study	85	2027-28	Operator balance sheet
Sipilou Ni-Co	NOCI / IC Nickel	Nickel/cobalt	Construction	280	2026-27 (indicative)	BERD + sponsor
Assafou (Tanda-Iguela)	Endeavour Mining	Gold	Permitting	410	H2 2028	Endeavour corporate
Samapleu Ni-Cu	Sama Resources / SODEMI	Nickel-copper	PFS	180	2028	Sponsor equity
Bénéné bauxite	Lagune Exploitation	Bauxite	Exploration → PFS	90	2028	Operator equity
Doropo	AngloGold Ashanti (via Centamin)	Gold	PEA / PFS	720	2029-30 (indicative)	Parent (AGA)
Didievi	Montage Gold	Gold	Exploration	230	2030 (indicative)	Montage equity
Tapeta lithium	Junior (TBD)	Lithium	Exploration	160	2030+	Junior equity

Table 3. Project pipeline register. Capex figures are disclosed or company-announced estimates where available; otherwise indicative. First-production dates marked "indicative" should be treated as company-stated targets pending FID and permitting. Sources: company filings and press releases [3][4][13][16][19][23].

Three implications follow from this pipeline. First, the 2026-2027 construction phase (Koné, SIMEP refinery, Bonikro extension, Yaouré underground, Sipilou Ni-Co) commits approximately USD 1.1 billion across the next 18 months and will deliver most of the near-term production additions. Second, the 2028-2030 pipeline (Assafou, Samapleu, Bénéné, Doropo, Didievi) commits another USD 1.6 billion but is exposed to permitting risk and to the revised Mining Code — fiscal terms agreed at FID will materially affect which projects proceed. Third, the late-stage exploration pipeline (Doropo, Didievi, Tapeta lithium) is the supply that would deliver the 100-tonne 2030 target under the upside scenario in §11; under the base scenario it does not arrive in time.

6.2 Capex breakdown by commodity and timing

The capex profile by commodity and stage shows where the sector's capital is concentrated. Of the USD 3.0 billion disclosed pipeline, gold accounts for roughly USD 2.13 billion (71%), nickel-cobalt for USD 460 million (15%), gold refining for USD 140 million (5%), bauxite for USD 90 million (3%) and lithium for USD 160 million (5%). The gold share is consistent with the sector's current composition but the nickel share is

notable: Sipilou Ni-Co (USD 280 million) and Samapleu Ni-Cu (USD 180 million) together commit USD 460 million to a commodity that has only just entered production, signalling that the energy-transition diversification story is real but still capital-intensive and early-stage.

The timing profile is more important than the commodity profile for the 2030 scenario. Roughly USD 1.1 billion (37% of disclosed capex) is committed to projects in the 2026-2027 construction wave — this is the capital that will determine whether the base scenario's 70-75 t output in 2030 is achieved. The 2028-2030 wave (USD 1.6 billion, 53%) is exposed to permitting and code-revision risk; this is the capital that determines whether the upside scenario can materialise. The post-2030 wave (USD 0.16 billion for Tapeta lithium) is too small and too far out to be a 2030 supply lever.

The funding mix is also worth noting. Of the twelve projects, four are funded by operator balance sheet or cash from operations (Bonikro, Séguéla, Yaouré, Didievi); two by parent-company equity (Doropo, Assafou); two by sponsor equity plus DFI debt (Sipilou with BERD, Samapleu); one by state and StoneX offtake (SIMEP); and three by junior equity. The DFI involvement at Sipilou and Samapleu is a notable signal: it suggests that the development-finance community is willing to back the energy-transition diversification story, which reduces the project's political-risk exposure relative to a pure private-equity funding structure.

6.3 Risks and dependencies in the pipeline

The project pipeline is exposed to four categories of risk that determine how much of the disclosed capex actually converts to production. Permitting risk: the time from PFS to FID to construction start can stretch from 18 months to 36 months or more if environmental, water, forestry or community approvals encounter difficulties; the Doropo project (AngloGold/AGA) is the largest project most exposed to this. Code-revision risk: the revised Mining Code, when enacted, will set the fiscal terms for all FIDs after enactment; projects that have already signed their convention under the 2014 Code (Koné, Yaouré, Bonikro) are ring-fenced, but Assafou, Doropo and Samapleu are all potentially exposed. Construction risk: standard mining-project construction risk (schedule, capex overrun, contractor performance) applies to the 2026-2027 construction wave; Koné is the largest single construction risk in this wave.

Operational risk: once in production, ramp-up to nameplate capacity typically takes 12-24 months for a new gold mine, and the Koné hard-rock circuit (due Q2 2027) is the most material ramp-up risk in the near-term pipeline. Commodity-price risk: the gold price assumption behind the 62-65 t 2026-27 forecasts is USD 2,400-2,800/oz; a sustained fall below USD 2,000/oz would call into question the FID economics of Doropo (the highest-capex project) and the Sipilou Ni-Co project (the most exposed to battery-metals price assumptions). Security risk: the northern-border spillover from Burkina Faso and Mali affects Tongon, Koné, Lafigué and the Doropo development project, and any escalation would compound with the construction risk at Doropo in particular. The risk register in §10 captures the sector-level view; this sub-section gives the project-level perspective that is most useful for the policy reader tracking the 2030 scenario.

6.4 Capex schedule by year

The capex schedule by year is the most useful view for understanding the timing of capital deployment and the project pipeline's cash demands on the sector. The table below shows the indicative capex schedule across the twelve projects, aggregated by year. The peak capex year is 2027, when the construction wave (Koné hard-rock, Assafou, Sipilou Ni-Co) and the SIMEP refinery all hit peak spend simultaneously.

Year	Gold (US$M)	Nickel/Co (US$M)	Refinery (US$M)	Other (US$M)	Total (US$M)
2026	320 (Koné ramp, Bonikro)	120 (Sipilou)	30 (SIMEP start)	15 (Bongouanou expansion)	485
2027	420 (Koné hard-rock, Assafou, Yaouré UG)	120 (Sipilou, Samapleu)	80 (SIMEP peak)	20 (Bénéné PFS)	640
2028	380 (Assafou peak, Séguéla expansion)	60 (Samapleu peak)	20 (SIMEP ops)	40 (Bénéné construction)	500
2029	480 (Doropo construction)	40 (Samapleu)	10 (SIMEP)	30 (Bénéné)	560
2030	350 (Doropo peak, Didievi start)	20 (Samapleu)	5	60 (Tapeta Li, REE)	435
Total	1,950	360	145	165	2,620

Table 12. Indicative capex schedule by year and commodity, based on disclosed project capex and company-announced construction schedules. Peak year is 2027 at approximately USD 640 million.

The schedule implies that the sector will deploy approximately USD 2.6 billion over the 2026-2030 period, with the bulk concentrated in 2027 (USD 640 million). The 2027 peak is the single most important financing event in the pipeline: if the capital markets and DFI lenders are open and the code revision is not too aggressive, the peak is financeable; if either condition fails, projects will defer and the base-case 2030 output trajectory in §11 will be at risk. The 2029-2030 decline in capex reflects the completion of the major projects rather than a slowdown in the pipeline; if Doropo and Didievi proceed as planned, the 2029-2030 capex will be higher than shown.

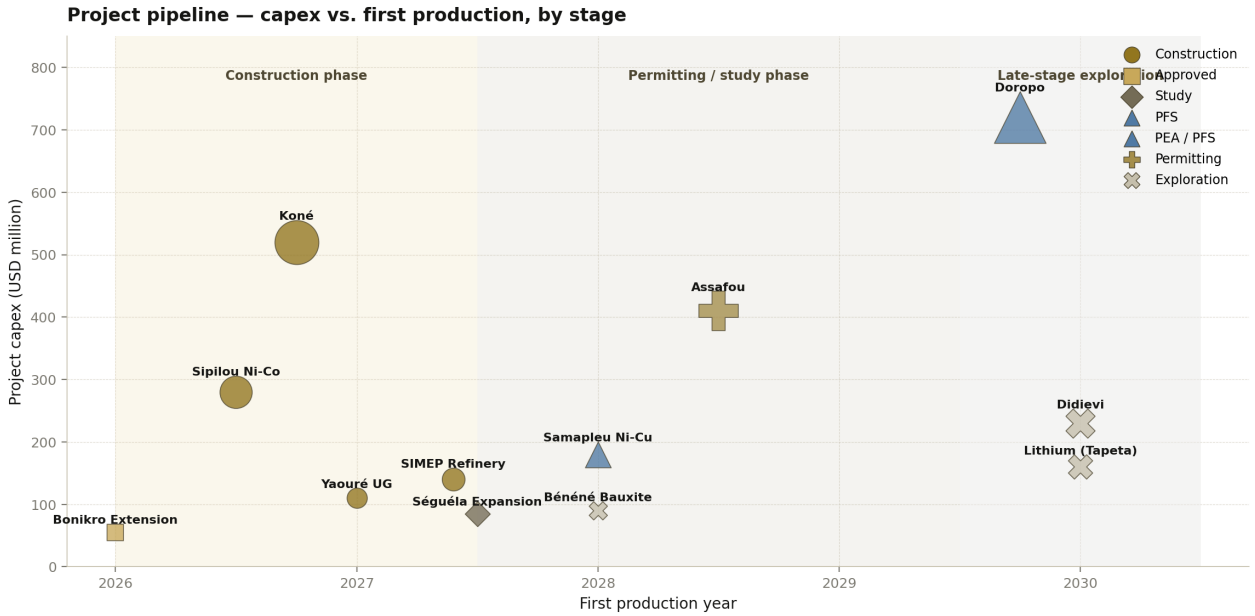


Figure 4. Project pipeline — capex versus first-production year, by stage. Bubble area is proportional to capex. Phase bands highlight the construction wave (2026-27), the permitting/study wave (2027-29) and the late-stage exploration wave (2029-30+).

7. Regulatory Framework & Fiscal Regime

7.1 Legal framework and institutions

The sector is governed by Law No. 2014-138 of 24 March 2014 (the Mining Code) and its implementing decree 2014-97 of 25 June 2014 [25][26]. As a UEMOA member state, Côte d'Ivoire is also subject to the Community Mining Code (Regulation 02/2023/CM/UEMOA) which creates a regional layer for cross-border mining issues. Related legislation includes the Environment Code (1996), the Water Code (1998), the Rural Land Code (1998), the Forestry Code (2014), the customs code, the 2018 Investment Code, and the Kimberley Process certificate rules for rough diamond exports [27].

The institutional architecture is concentrated. The Council of Ministers decides on granting and withdrawing mining titles; the Directorate General of Mines and Geology (DGMG) handles technical evaluation; SODEMI is the state mining company and minority partner in most exploitation permits. Since September 2025 an e-cadastre portal has digitalised title management, which has visibly improved throughput: 151 of 189 applications granted in 2023, 160 of 203 in 2024, and 171 of 225 in 2025 [28]. Recent Council of Ministers decisions include four exploration permits adopted on 22 July 2026 and three more on 5 August 2026 [23][24].

7.2 Title types and durations

Title	Duration	Renewals	Area limit	Key fees
Exploration permit	4 years	2 × 3 years	400–4,000 km^2 (sliding)	Surface + processing fees; non-transferable
Small-scale exploitation	5 years	Renewable	≤ 50 km^2	Reduced royalty schedule; local entity required
Semi-mechanised exploitation	5 years	Renewable	≤ 100 km^2	SIMEP scope; rehab bond required
Industrial exploitation	20 years	Renewable up to 10-yr increments	Per permit area	Full fiscal regime; convention required
Quarry permit	5 years	Renewable	Per permit area	Environmental impact assessment required

Table 4. Mining title types and key terms under the 2014 Code (and subsequent implementing decrees). Counsel should verify all terms against the actual law and decree text before relying on this summary for transactional work. Sources: Fasken [25], Mondaq [26], A-MLA [27].

7.3 Fiscal terms and the 2025 stability disapplication

The 2014 Code established a sliding-scale gold royalty of 3-6% of sales plus a profit share tied to the State's stake. The most important fiscal event in the sector's recent history is the 2025 finance law, which raised the ad valorem tax on gold by two percentage points and disapplied Article 164 of the Mining Code — the fiscal stability clause — for those revisions [5]. The practical consequence is that existing mining conventions did not protect operators from the increase, despite the original bargain in the 2014 Code. Perseus Mining has publicly reported paying approximately USD 20 million of additional royalties, including amounts for earlier periods, which is the most concrete data point available on the magnitude of the change [5].

The 2014 Code also granted a five-year corporate income-tax exemption from first commercial production. Perseus's Yaouré holiday expired on 31 December 2025 — the first major expiry — and similar expiries will follow at the other first-wave mines as they pass their fifth anniversary. The combined effect of the royalty increase and the tax-holiday expiries is a structurally higher effective tax burden across the sector, which the State has signalled it intends to consolidate through the revised Mining Code (see §7.5).

7.4 Other mandatory contributions

Beyond royalties and income tax, the 2014 Code imposes several mandatory contributions that are easy to miss in headline fiscal analysis. Local community development funds require operators to ring-fence a share of revenue (typically 0.5-1.0%) for community projects in the mine's host area, governed by a community development agreement (CDA) negotiated with local authorities. Mine rehabilitation obligations require a rehabilitation plan and a financial guarantee deposited upfront or annually, with the amount scaled to the closure liability estimate. Artisanal mining is regulated under a separate licensing regime (carte d'orpailleur) and the 100 local technical committees set up between 2014 and 2024 under the national artisanal mining rationalisation programme are the operational arm of formalisation [29].

7.5 Code revision status

The Minister of Mines announced in July 2024 that the Mining Code would be revised to increase the State's share of mining profits [6]. A draft was expected to be submitted to the Government Secretariat General in November 2025, with local content provisions folded into the revised code. As of October 2026 there is no evidence that a new code has been enacted: Endeavour Mining was still describing convention negotiations for Assafou under the 2014 Code in mid-2026 [16]. The practical read is to expect a revised code with a larger State share, local content rules, and possibly local processing requirements aligned with the regional trend (see §9), but to verify current status with counsel before relying on specific provisions.

7.6 FX, repatriation and dispute resolution

Côte d'Ivoire is a UEMOA member and uses the CFA franc (XOF), pegged to the euro at a fixed rate and backed by the French Treasury. Foreign exchange and repatriation rules are governed by UEMOA/BCEAO regulations: gold-export proceeds must be repatriated through the local banking system within stipulated periods, and conversion to foreign currency is subject to BCEAO rules. The gold export and sales procedure will change with the SIMEP national buying office and the Abidjan refinery, which will sit between exporters and the offshore market; the precise interaction with the existing dore-export regime is still being defined [8][9].

Dispute resolution for foreign investors typically relies on bilateral investment treaties (BITs) — Côte d'Ivoire has BITs in force with, among others, France, the UK, the United States, China, South Africa and Canada — providing ICSID access for investor-State arbitration. Mining conventions separately provide for commercial arbitration (often ICC, seated in Paris) of contractual disputes with the State. The 2025 disapplication of Article 164 stability is the most important recent test case: whether affected operators will pursue arbitration under their BITs and conventions, or accept the change as a tax increase absorbed into operating cost, is the open question for the sector's risk profile. Côte d'Ivoire's EITI status is implementing and beneficial-ownership disclosure rules are at an early stage of operationalisation — both should be tracked as the code revision advances [30].

7.7 Mining convention architecture

Every industrial mining project in Côte d'Ivoire operates under a mining convention (convention minière) signed with the State and ratified by decree. The convention is the binding document that operationalises the 2014 Code's general provisions at the project level, and it is the document that Article 164 of the Code (the fiscal-stability clause) was originally designed to protect. A typical convention covers: the permit area and term; the fiscal regime applicable (royalty rate, income-tax holiday, withholding rates, depreciation schedule); the State's free-carried interest and any SODEMI participation; local content obligations; community development commitments; environmental obligations and rehabilitation guarantees; FX, repatriation and export procedures; and dispute resolution clauses (typically ICC commercial arbitration for contractual disputes, with BIT-based ICSID access for investor-State disputes).

The convention architecture is the channel through which the 2025 Article 164 disapplication bites. Even though conventions pre-dating the 2025 finance law included a fiscal-stability clause that was supposed to lock the royalty rate for the life of the mine, the 2025 law disapplied that protection for the +2pp ad valorem increase, meaning operators cannot rely on the convention as a complete fiscal shield. The Assafou convention negotiation under the 2014 Code will be the test case for how the State approaches fiscal stability going forward: a convention that explicitly restores a credible stability commitment, ring-fenced for new projects,

would help restore investor confidence; a convention that preserves the 2025 disapplication as the new baseline would entrench the fiscal squeeze [16].

7.8 Artisanal mining rules and licensing

Artisanal mining is regulated under a separate regime from industrial mining. The 2014 Code provides for a carte d'orpailleur (artisanal miner's card) issued by the DGMG, valid for a defined area and renewable annually; it restricts artisanal operations to Ivorian nationals and to areas designated by the Ministry. Semi-mechanised exploitation is a separate permit category, intended for artisanal cooperatives that have moved beyond manual extraction but are below the threshold for an industrial permit; this is the category that SIMEP is intended to occupy directly. The 100 local technical committees set up between 2014 and 2024 are the field operational arm of formalisation, with a mandate to register and supervise artisanal sites [29].

The practical challenge is that the formal artisanal regime covers only a fraction of the actual ASM workforce — most artisanal miners operate outside the formal system, often on sites that overlap with industrial exploration permits or in border areas where smuggling to Ghana, Mali or Burkina Faso is the dominant offtake route. The SIMEP national buying office is intended to formalise offtake rather than to formalise extraction: by providing a state-backed offtake price, it is intended to draw ASM gold into the formal economy without requiring the entire ASM workforce to hold formal permits. This is the same logic that has driven Ghana's formal ASM purchases to 54 t in H1 2026 — and it is the model that Côte d'Ivoire is now attempting to replicate [32].

7.9 Counsel checklist for new investments

For a counsel reader advising a new entrant in Cote d'Ivoire, the following checklist captures the items that most often determine the success or failure of a new mining investment. Title: confirm the permit is in good standing on the e-cadastre portal and that all annual fees are paid; verify the title boundary against the survey and any overlapping permits. Convention: review the draft mining convention against the 2014 Code and recent precedents (Ity, Lafigue, Kone); specifically verify the stability clause language in light of the 2025 Article 164 disapplication, and the BIT-based dispute resolution fallback. Local content: confirm the supplier-development obligations and whether they are prescriptive or outcome-based. Community: review the CDA template and any precedent CDAs at the host community level.

Environmental: confirm the environmental impact assessment is approved, the rehabilitation bond level is set, and the tailings management plan is aligned with GISTM (if the investor is an ICMM member) or with the operator's own tailings standard. Fiscal: model the effective tax rate at steady-state, taking into account the post-2025 royalty rate (sliding 5-8% plus the +2pp ad valorem), the expiring CIT holiday, the State 10% free-carry (non-contributing) and any SODEMI 5-10% carried interest (which may be contributing or non-contributing depending on the convention). FX and repatriation: confirm the BCEAO rules on export proceeds repatriation and the interaction with the planned SIMEP refinery offtake. Each item should be confirmed against the actual law, decree and convention text by Ivorian counsel before the FID.

7.10 Mining convention precedent comparison

Mining conventions in Côte d'Ivoire have evolved through several generations since 2014, with each major project setting precedent for the next. The table below compares the key terms across the most cited

conventions; the trend is toward tighter fiscal terms and more explicit local content and community obligations, but the State 10% free-carry and the convention architecture have remained stable.

Convention	Year signed	State / SODEMI stake	Royalty	CIT holiday	Stability clause
Ity (Endeavour)	2014-17	10% / 5%	3-6% sliding	5 yr (lapsed)	Art. 164 (pre-2025 protection held)
Yaouré (Perseus)	2018	10% / 0%	3-6% sliding	5 yr (expired 31 Dec 2025)	Art. 164 (pre-2025 protection held)
Séguéla (Fortuna/Roxgold Sango)	2020	10% / 0%	3-6% sliding	5 yr (active to 2028)	Art. 164 (held; post-2025 hike applied to all)
Lafigué (Endeavour)	2023	10% / 5%	3-6% sliding	5 yr (active to 2029)	Art. 164 (held; post-2025 hike applied)
Koné (Montage)	2025	10% / 0%	3-6% sliding + 2pp	5 yr (active from 2027)	Art. 164 disapplied for the +2pp increase
Tongon (Atlantic, post-Barrick)	2025-26	10% / 5% (assumed)	3-6% sliding + 2pp	Lapsed (Barrick era holiday expired)	Art. 164 disapplied for the +2pp increase
Assafou (Endeavour, under negotiation)	2026-27 (expected)	10% / 5% (expected)	Post-2025 regime (sliding + 2pp)	5 yr from first prod. (expected)	Key test case: does the revised code restore credible stability?

Table 13. Mining convention precedent comparison. The trend shows the State 10% free-carry as the stable element, while the fiscal terms and stability commitment have tightened. The Assafou convention is the key test case for the revised code.

8. Fiscal Contribution & Price Sensitivity

Côte d'Ivoire's mining sector contributes to the State through four channels: royalties (sliding 3-6% plus the 2025 +2pp ad valorem increase), corporate income tax (after the five-year holiday), SODEMI dividends on the State's free-carried and SODEMI-held interests, and community development fund contributions. The 2025 Perseus disclosure of approximately USD 20 million of additional royalties — including amounts for earlier periods — is the most concrete data point available on the magnitude of the 2025 fiscal change [5]. Across the sector, if the 2pp increase is applied uniformly to the 62-tonne 2026 output at a USD 2,600/oz gold price, the incremental royalty alone is in the order of USD 100 million per year, before any income-tax effect from expiring holidays.

Channel	Estimated 2026 contribution	Source basis	Trend
Gold royalty (3-6% + 2pp)	US$ 320-380 million (illustrative)	62 t × US$2,600/oz × ~6% blended rate	Rising (2025 hike + holiday expiries)
Corporate income tax	US$ 80-150 million (rising)	First-wave holiday expiries 2025-28	Rising sharply
SODEMI dividends	US$ 15-30 million	10% State + 5-10% SODEMI across mines	Stable, growing with output
Community development funds	US$ 10-20 million	~0.5-1.0% of revenue per CDA	Stable, scaling with revenue
Rehabilitation bonds	Off-balance-sheet	Annual deposit against closure liability	Rising with new projects
Export share of GDP	Mining ~3-4% of GDP (incl. O&G;)	Ministry / 2022 data [1]	Rising as Koné, Assafou ramp up
Employment	~30,000 direct + 100,000 ASM	94% Ivorian by 2019 (GIZ 2022) [10]	Stable; ASM formalisation priority

Table 5. Fiscal contribution channels. Estimates are illustrative — derived from disclosed royalty rates and production, not from Ministry of Finance tax receipts. Confirm with the 2026 finance law and the EITI report when published.

Gold price sensitivity is the single largest swing factor for State revenue. The 62-65 tonne 2026 output forecasts implicitly assume a gold price in the USD 2,400-2,800/oz range. A USD 100/oz move in the gold price — roughly a 4% change at mid-2026 levels — translates to roughly USD 50 million of additional royalty revenue at the 2026 output level (62 t × 32,150 oz/t × USD 100 × 6% royalty = ~USD 12 million per percentage point of royalty, or about USD 60 million for the +2pp increase alone). The contingent element of the Tongon sale price — USD 113 million tied to the gold price and resource-conversion milestones — is a direct price-sensitivity exposure for Atlantic Group, and an indirect exposure for the State through its 10% interest in the mine [7].

8.2 Mining's macroeconomic contribution

Beyond the direct fiscal channels, the sector's macroeconomic contribution operates through three additional pathways: export diversification (gold is now the second-largest merchandise export after cocoa), infrastructure investment (the road, power and water infrastructure built for the industrial mines is a permanent addition to the country's stock, with positive spillovers for agriculture and other industries), and skills transfer (the 94% Ivorian workforce has built a domestic skills base in mining engineering, geology, metallurgy and mining-finance that is a structural asset for the sector's next phase).

These indirect contributions are harder to quantify than royalties and tax, but they are the channels through which the sector delivers long-run value to the economy. The SIMEP refinery, for example, will add value locally to gold that is currently exported as dore — capturing the refining margin inside the country rather than in Switzerland or South Africa. The local-content push, if it succeeds in developing domestic suppliers of grinding media, reagents and fabricated steel, will reduce import leakage and increase the sector's net fiscal contribution. These are slow-burn effects but they compound: by 2030 the sector's indirect contribution may be roughly equal in size to its direct fiscal contribution.

8.3 EITI status and disclosure

Côte d'Ivoire has been an EITI implementing country since 2008 and has published several EITI reports covering payments by mining and oil-and-gas companies to the State, reconciled against company disclosures. The most recent EITI reports provide the most authoritative public data on the actual fiscal contribution of the sector, although publication lag means the 2025 royalty increase and its effects will only appear in reports covering 2025-26 (likely published 2027-28). Beneficial-ownership disclosure rules are at an early stage of operationalisation: the e-cadastre portal launched in September 2025 is the technical platform that could host beneficial-ownership data, but the legal framework requiring disclosure is still being developed [28][30].

For the policy reader, the EITI process is the cheapest reputational-insurance lever available: it does not require new legislation, it builds on existing institutional capacity, and it demonstrably reduces corruption risk in the sector. The 12 recommendations in §12 include accelerating EITI compliance and operationalising beneficial-ownership disclosure as a near-term priority, ahead of the more complex code revision and refinery implementation tasks. EITI is the lever that can move fastest and build trust for the harder reforms.

8.4 Worked fiscal example for a 200 koz/yr mine

To illustrate the fiscal mechanics, consider a hypothetical 200 koz/yr gold mine at a USD 2,600/oz gold price, with the post-2025 royalty regime and the CIT holiday expired. Gross revenue = 200,000 oz times USD 2,600 = USD 520 million. Royalty (sliding 5% + 2pp ad valorem = 7% blended) = USD 36.4 million. Operating cost (at AISC USD 1,100/oz) = USD 220 million. EBITDA = USD 263.6 million. Depreciation and amortisation (assume USD 80 million per year) gives pre-tax profit of USD 183.6 million. Corporate income tax at 25% (post-holiday) = USD 45.9 million. State 10% free-carry dividend share of post-tax profit (90% to operator times 10% to State) = USD 13.8 million. SODEMI 5% carried (if contributing at 5%) = USD 6.9 million. Total State take = royalty + tax + dividends = USD 36.4M + USD 45.9M + USD 13.8M + USD 6.9M = USD 103 million, or roughly 19.8% of gross revenue.

The worked example is illustrative but shows three things. First, the royalty is now a meaningful but not dominant component of State take - corporate income tax is the larger component once the holiday expires. Second, the State free-carry and SODEMI carried interest together capture roughly 4-5% of gross revenue

through dividends, which is a non-trivial share and one that does not show up in headline fiscal-rate comparisons. Third, the effective State-take share under the post-2025 regime is meaningfully higher than under the pre-2025 regime, where the same mine would have paid roughly USD 17 million less in royalty (at 5% instead of 7%) and zero income tax (under the holiday) - total State take would have been roughly USD 70 million, or 13.5% of gross revenue. The fiscal squeeze between the two regimes is roughly 6 percentage points of gross revenue, which is the size of the policy shift the sector has absorbed.

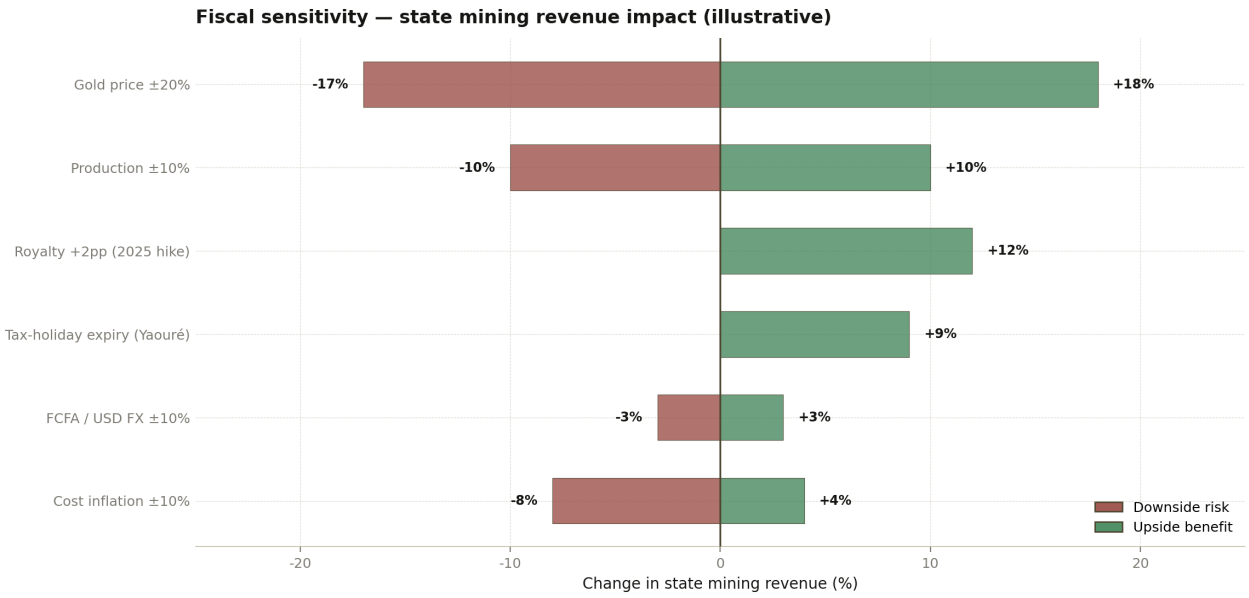


Figure 5. Fiscal sensitivity — illustrative impact of one-variable shocks on State mining revenue. Gold price and production are symmetric shocks; the 2025 royalty hike and tax-holiday expiries are one-way upward contributions that compound with the symmetric shocks.

9. Regional Comparison

Côte d'Ivoire competes with Ghana, Mali, Burkina Faso and Guinea for mining investment in the Birimian belt. GlobalData expects Côte d'Ivoire to become West Africa's third-largest gold producer in 2026, surpassing Mali — but this rests on Mali's 2025 disruption and a forecast 28% rebound, so the overtaking is fragile [31]. Ghana remains Africa's largest producer with 187 t of output in 2025, and the gap between Ghana and Côte d'Ivoire is largely a function of formalised artisanal output: Ghana's formal artisanal purchases alone were up to 54 t in H1 2026, which is roughly comparable to Côte d'Ivoire's entire 2026 industrial output [32]. This is an ASM-formalisation gap, not an industrial-output gap.

Metric	Côte d'Ivoire	Ghana	Mali	Burkina Faso	Guinea
2025 gold output (t)	59.33	187.0	~50 (disrupted)	~110	~75
Royalty rate	3-6% + 2pp (2025)	5% (sliding)	3-6% + State 20% (new)	3-5%	4-6%
State free-carry	10%	10%	20% (revised)	10%	15%
Export / refining rule	Refinery H1 2027 (planned); no export ban	Refining planned; no ban	Mandatory refining since 2023	Mandatory refining since 2018	Raw gold export ban June 2026
Code revision status	Pending (draft Nov 2025 target)	2014 code; no major revision	2023 revision (more state take)	Stable	Under revision

Metric	Côte d'Ivoire	Ghana	Mali	Burkina Faso	Guinea
Tax holiday (CIT)	5 yr from first prod. (expiring)	Stable	Reduced	Reduced	Variable
Security profile	Northern-border spillover (BF/Mali)	Stable	High (coups, sanctions)	Very high (jihadist insurgency)	Moderate (post-coup normalising)
EITI status	Implementing	Compliant	Compliant (suspended 2022-24)	Compliant	Candidate

Table 6. Regional comparison — Côte d'Ivoire vs. Ghana, Mali, Burkina Faso, Guinea. Sources: World Gold Council, Ecofin [5][32], national EITI reports, USGS.

The comparison makes three points for the policy reader. First, Côte d'Ivoire's royalty rate is now closer to the regional average after the 2025 +2pp increase — it is no longer the cheapest jurisdiction in the Birimian, but it is still cheaper than Mali (which doubled the State free-carry to 20% in 2023) and roughly comparable to Ghana. Second, the regional trend is unmistakably toward more State take and local refining: Mali mandated refining in 2023, Burkina Faso since 2018, Guinea banned raw gold exports in June 2026, and Côte d'Ivoire's SIMEP refinery opens after H1 2027 [8][33]. Côte d'Ivoire is on the same direction of travel but has so far stopped short of an export ban, which keeps it investor-friendly relative to Guinea. Third, the security differential is real: northern-border spillover from Burkina Faso and Mali affects Tongon and Koné, but the country remains comparatively stable relative to the Sahel — which is a key reason investors pivoting from Mali and Burkina Faso are landing in Côte d'Ivoire.

9.2 Cross-border issues and investment flows

The cross-border issues that most affect Côte d'Ivoire's mining sector are: the joint monitoring arrangement with Ghana on the Bia and Tanoé rivers, which run across the border and have been affected by illegal mining on both sides [34]; the ASM gold smuggling routes that historically ran from Côte d'Ivoire through Mali and Burkina Faso to the UAE, which Ghana's formalisation drive is also intended to redirect [32]; the investor flows from Mali and Burkina Faso to Côte d'Ivoire that have accelerated since the 2023 Mali convention dispute and the tightening of terms in Burkina Faso; and the regional resource-nationalism trend toward mandatory refining (Mali 2023, Burkina Faso 2018, Guinea June 2026 export ban), which is forcing Côte d'Ivoire to define its position in the regional policy space.

The investment-flow story is the most material for the medium-term supply curve. Several of the operators and juniors active in Côte d'Ivoire today entered the country after consolidating or exiting positions in Mali or Burkina Faso: Fortuna's Séguéla acquisition (via Roxgold) is the clearest example, and the 2026 permit awards to Barrick and Avesoro (despite Barrick's Tongon exit) suggest that the country is the preferred destination for West African exploration capital flowing out of the Sahel. The policy implication is that any code revision that materially raises the State take risks slowing this inflow — which is the single most important determinant of whether the 100-tonne 2030 target can be met.

9.3 Investor perspective: why CI today

From an investor's perspective, the case for allocating West African mining capital to Côte d'Ivoire in 2026 rests on four pillars. Geological prospectivity: the country has 35% of the Birimian greenstone belts and remains less explored than Ghana or Mali at comparable scales. Political stability: the country has had continuous civilian government since 2011 and post-electoral continuity after the 2025 presidential election, in contrast to the Sahel. Regulatory predictability: the 2014 Code, even with the 2025 Article 164 disapplication, remains more investor-friendly than Mali's 2023 revision or Guinea's June 2026 export ban, and the convention architecture provides a familiar structure for investors from other West African jurisdictions. Infrastructure: the Abidjan port and grid power are more reliable than in most Sahel jurisdictions, although the §13 infrastructure chapter identifies the gaps that are emerging as the sector scales.

The counter-arguments are also worth stating. The 2025 fiscal squeeze was a real signal that the State is willing to revise fiscal terms mid-convention, which raises the required rate of return for new investments. The northern-border security risk is a real operating cost for the northern mines and a real capital cost for the Doropo development project. The code revision is the dominant near-term uncertainty: a revision that preserves investor economics will sustain the inflow; a revision that materially tightens terms will redirect capital to other jurisdictions. The investor perspective and the policy perspective are therefore aligned on the code revision: both want a code that captures more value for the State without deterring the investment that creates the value in the first place.

9.4 Investment-flow indicators by jurisdiction

A practical way to gauge where West African mining capital is flowing is to look at the distribution of recent permit awards and project FIDs across the Birimian jurisdictions. The table below provides a comparative snapshot of investment-flow indicators as of October 2026.

Indicator	Côte d'Ivoire	Ghana	Mali	BF	Guinea
2025 permit awards (count)	171	~190	~75 (disrupted)	~120 (security-constrained)	~85
2024-26 FIDs (count)	6	4	2	3	2
Active juniors (count)	~80	~95	~50	~60	~55
Chinese-investor presence	Growing (Sipilou, bauxite, Allied Gold/Zijin reports)	Limited	Limited (post-sanctions)	Limited	Significant (Simandou)
DFI involvement	BERD (Sipilou); IFC (Endeavour)	IFC; AfDB	Limited	Limited	IFC; AfDB
EPC contractor market depth	High (Lycopodium, DRA, China firms)	High	Moderate (post-disruption)	Moderate (security)	Moderate
2-yr capex outlook (US$M)	~2,620	~1,800	~700	~1,200	~1,400

Table 18. Investment-flow indicators by jurisdiction — comparative snapshot as of October 2026. Counts are approximate. Côte d'Ivoire leads on permit awards and capex outlook; Ghana leads on active juniors and DFI depth.

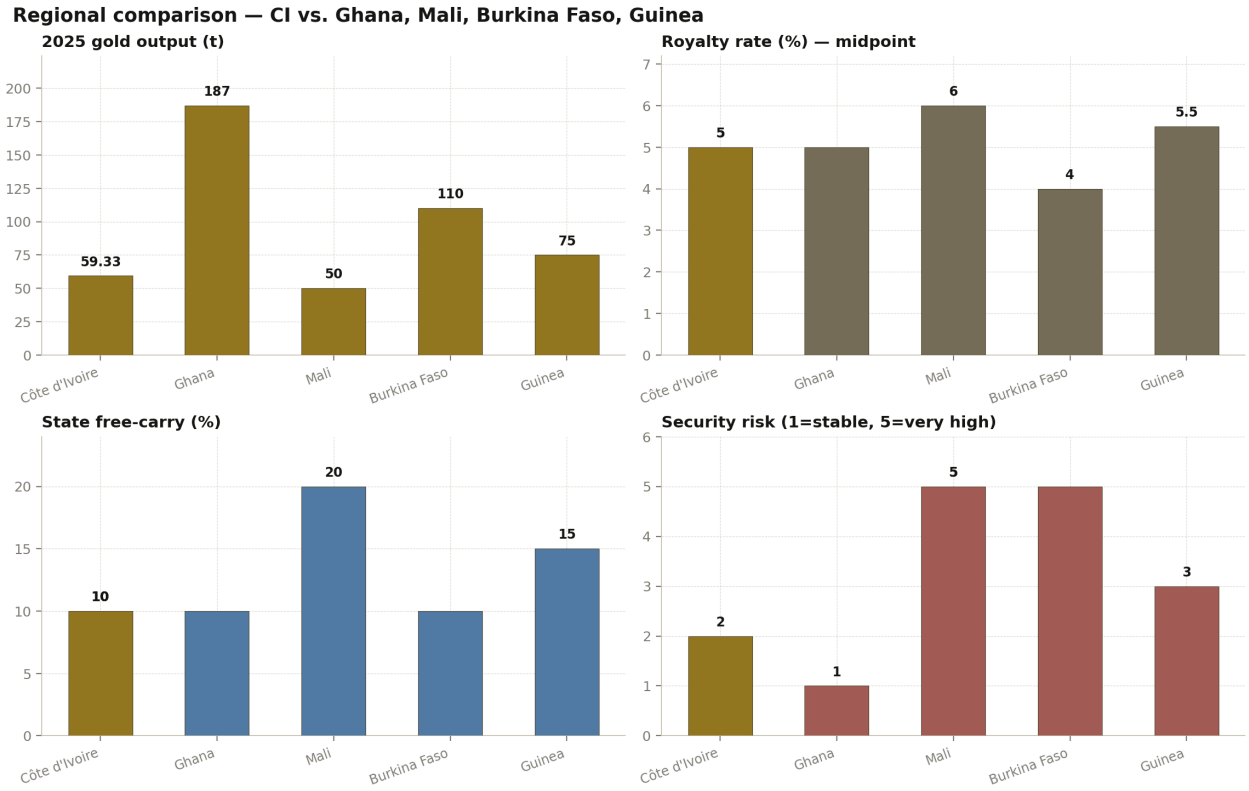


Figure 6. Regional comparison — four key metrics across Côte d'Ivoire, Ghana, Mali, Burkina Faso and Guinea. Côte d'Ivoire (gold bar) is the third-largest producer, with mid-pack royalty and free-carry terms, and the lowest security-risk score among the Birimian producers outside Ghana.

10. Risk, ESG & Community

The sector's risk profile has tightened on the fiscal and regulatory side (see §7 and §8) but loosened on the security and environmental side. The most material physical risk is the spillover from the northern border with Burkina Faso and Mali, which directly affects the northern mines — Tongon, Koné, Sissingué, Lafigué and the Doropo development project. Operations have not been disrupted at industrial mines in 2026, but the border départements are under elevated security management, and any escalation would compound with the cost of insurance, logistics and personnel rotation. The political context after the 2025 presidential election has so far delivered policy continuity — the Minister of Mines is unchanged — but the post-electoral agenda includes the code revision, the SIMEP refinery and the local content push, which together represent a meaningful change in the operating environment even without a change of government.

Risk	Severity (1-5)	Likelihood (1-5)	Direction	Mitigation / status
Northern-border security spillover (Tongon, Koné, Doropo)	4	3	Rising	Military presence; insurance premium; monitoring; alternative routes
Code revision delays / scope creep	3	4	Rising	Stakeholder consultation; counsel tracking; preserve BIT/convention protections

Risk	Severity (1-5)	Likelihood (1-5)	Direction	Mitigation / status
Fiscal-stability disapplication (post-2025 precedent)	4	4	Materialised	Already a 2025 reality; future disputes may test BIT protections
Royalty / tax-holiday expiry impact on operator returns	3	5	Materialising	Built into 2026 cost guidance; convention re-negotiations underway
Mercury / cyanide use in ASM (Bia, Tanoé rivers)	4	4	Stable	Joint monitoring with Ghana; mercury phase-out; SIMEP formalisation
Mining in classified forests (forestry code conflict)	3	3	Rising	Permit-level case-by-case; compensation regime evolving
Community resettlement at large projects (Koné, Assafou, Doropo)	4	3	Rising	CDAs; livelihood restoration; grievance mechanisms
Power supply interruptions (CIE grid)	3	3	Stable	On-site backup; grid investment; renewables integration
Port logistics (Abidjan / San Pedro) for dore and manganese	2	3	Stable	Capacity expansion at both ports; SIMEP refinery to reduce dore export volume
Reagent and fuel logistics (Abidjan corridor)	3	3	Stable	Multiple sourcing; CFA-denominated where possible
Allied Gold / Zijin takeover impact on Bonikro, Agbaou	3	3	Pending confirmation	Monitor; reassess operator register on confirmation

Table 7. Risk register. Severity and likelihood are qualitative scores on a 1-5 scale (5 = highest). Direction describes the trend in the last 12 months. Materialised = the risk has already become a realised event. Counsel and ESG specialists should validate scores for transactional use.

The environmental and social agenda is increasingly visible. Mercury and cyanide use in artisanal and small-scale mining remains the single largest environmental liability: the joint monitoring arrangement with Ghana on the Bia and Tanoé rivers, which run across the border and have been affected by illegal mining, is the main bilateral mechanism for managing the issue [34]. Mining in classified forests — where the Forestry Code and the Mining Code interact — is a growing area of permit-level controversy, and the rehabilitation obligations under the 2014 Code are the main financial safeguard. Community resettlement at the larger projects (Koné, Assafou, Doropo) is a structural ESG issue, managed through Community Development Agreements (CDAs), livelihood restoration programmes and grievance mechanisms, but it is also a source of operational and reputational risk that scales with project size.

The PIRME 2026-2040 — the integrated mineral and energy policy built around local processing and industrial upgrading — is the umbrella framework for the sector's ESG and industrial policy [35]. Local content, as assessed by the GIZ-funded 2022 study, shows the national employment target was exceeded (94% Ivorian by 2019) but supply-chain gaps remain in subcontracting and specialised services [10]. The 100 local technical committees set up between 2014 and 2024 under the national artisanal mining rationalisation programme are the operational arm of ASM formalisation, but many artisanal operators still work informally and the SIMEP national buying office is intended to draw them into the formal market. Tongon's contingent-payment structure (USD 113 million tied to gold price and resource-conversion milestones) is an interesting precedent for ESG-linked deal structuring that may be replicated elsewhere [7].

10.2 ESG frameworks and climate exposure

ESG reporting across the Ivorian mining sector is uneven. The larger operators (Endeavour, Perseus, Fortuna, AngloGold, Montage) publish annual sustainability reports aligned with GRI and SASB standards, and several are ICMM members subject to the ICMM Mining Principles. Smaller operators and junior explorers typically do not publish sustainability reports, which creates a transparency gap that the revised Mining Code and the EITI process could close by making basic ESG reporting a permit-level obligation. The SIMEP refinery, with its state stake and StoneX offtake, will be a test case for whether the value-capture agenda can be combined with credible ESG disclosure, or whether it inherits the opacity that has historically characterised national buying offices in the region.

Climate exposure is a growing but under-discussed risk. The industrial mines are not directly vulnerable to sea-level rise (most are inland at 200-500m elevation) but are exposed to changing rainfall patterns through water supply for processing operations, tailings management, and access-road integrity. Côte d'Ivoire's National Climate Change Programme and the updated NDC (2025) include mining-sector provisions but are not yet operationalised at the permit level. The rehabilitation bonds required under the 2014 Code are the main existing climate-resilience instrument, but they are calibrated to closure liability rather than to climate adaptation.

10.3 Tailings, water and rehabilitation

Tailings management has become a globally visible ESG issue after the Brumadinho (2019) and Jagersfontein (2022) failures. Côte d'Ivoire's industrial gold mines all operate conventional slurry tailings facilities — none have transitioned to filtered or paste tailings — and the standards applied at the larger operations follow the ICMM Global Industry Standard on Tailings Management (GISTM), which the ICMM members in the sector have committed to implement. The smaller and junior operators have not made the same commitment, and the regulatory framework does not yet require GISTM compliance. The revised Mining Code is the natural channel to introduce this requirement, which would close the ESG gap between the larger operators and the rest of the sector.

Water and rehabilitation are the two environmental liabilities most often under-provisioned in the sector. Water: most industrial gold mines are in the Birimian greenstone belts with seasonal rainfall, and process water is supplied by a combination of recycled tailings water, seasonal storage reservoirs and groundwater. The Bia and Tanoé river systems are the most monitored because of the joint arrangement with Ghana, but water-use reporting at other sites is not standardised. Rehabilitation: the 2014 Code requires a rehabilitation plan and financial guarantee, but the level of the guarantee and the timing of deposit are not standardised, which means some operations are under-provisioned for closure. Both issues are candidates for the revised code.

10.4 Community expectations and CDA practice

Community Development Agreements (CDAs) are the institutional bridge between mining operations and host communities. Under the 2014 Code, every industrial mining permit requires a CDA negotiated with the host community, with a defined revenue share (typically 0.5-1.0% of revenue) committed to community projects. CDA practice across the sector is uneven: the larger operators (Endeavour, Perseus, Fortuna) have well-developed CDA frameworks with multi-year investment plans, governance structures and grievance mechanisms; smaller operators often have minimal CDAs that meet the legal requirement without delivering

substantive community benefit.

Community expectations have risen faster than CDA practice has matured. The Koné, Assafou and Doropo projects will all require resettlement at meaningful scale, and the country's experience with resettlement at earlier projects (Ity, Yaouré, Séguéla) has been mixed. Livelihood restoration — the commitment to leave displaced households at least as well off as before displacement — is the most contested element, and IFC Performance Standard 5 (the international benchmark) is not yet uniformly applied across the sector. The revised Mining Code is the natural channel to standardise CDA practice, mandate IFC PS5 alignment for resettlement, and create a transparent registry of CDAs and resettlement outcomes that the EITI process can use as a disclosure anchor.

11. 2030 Scenario View

The 100-tonne national target by 2030 is the policy anchor for the sector, but all three scenarios in this report's framework fall short of it. The base case (probability approximately 55%) delivers 70-75 t of gold in 2030, driven by the full ramp-up of Koné (223 koz/yr average over 16 years from the 2024 FS), the Séguéla expansion (>200 koz/yr), Lafigué's steady-state, and a partial first-year contribution from Assafou. The upside case (probability approximately 20%) reaches 85-90 t if Doropo and Afema deliver by 2029, Didievi adds incremental output, the formalised ASM sector contributes an additional 10-15 t through the SIMEP buying office, and a new discovery or two enters production. The downside case (probability approximately 25%) delivers 55-60 t if the code revision deters investment, northern-border security deteriorates enough to disrupt operations, the gold price falls below USD 2,000/oz, and manganese grade decline continues.

The arithmetic gap is the headline finding. Under the base case the gap to the 100-tonne target is 25-30 t — roughly the size of a single new world-class mine plus a meaningful ASM contribution. Under the upside the gap is still 10-15 t. Closing the gap requires a step-change in either project delivery (Doropo and Afema in production by 2029, not 2030) or in ASM formalisation (Ghana's formal artisanal sector alone produces 50+ t per year). The 100-t target is not implausible — it is achievable in the early 2030s if the policy levers (SIMEP, code revision, infrastructure) align — but it is a stretch for 2030 specifically.

Each scenario has distinct fiscal and policy implications. The base case implies continued fiscal-take growth but at a decelerating rate, with State revenue roughly USD 600-700 million per year by 2030 from gold royalties and income tax alone. The upside case implies roughly USD 750-850 million and creates headroom for the SIMEP refinery, local content investment and the critical-minerals push. The downside case implies roughly USD 450-500 million and would force a re-prioritisation between the domestication agenda (SIMEP, SODEMI stakes) and the investment-promotion agenda (code revision terms, exploration incentives) — these two agendas are complementary in the upside but in tension in the downside.

11.1 Scenario assumptions and probability reasoning

The scenario probabilities are deliberately approximate, but the reasoning behind them is transparent. The base case (55%) assumes that the projects in the 2026-2027 construction wave deliver on company-announced schedules, that the code revision is submitted and enacted without materially deterring the 2028-2030 project wave, that the SIMEP refinery starts after H1 2027 as planned, and that ASM formalisation adds 2-3 t per year

of additional formal output by 2030. None of these assumptions is heroic, but each is exposed to a specific risk (project delay, code-revision scope, refinery timing, ASM policy follow-through), and the probability reflects the combined risk that at least one of them fails to materialise as assumed.

The upside case (20%) requires the late-stage projects (Doropo, Afema, Didievi) to deliver by 2029 rather than 2030 — a one-year acceleration of the current schedule — plus a step-change in ASM formalisation that adds 10-15 t per year by 2030, plus at least one new discovery entering production. Each of these is plausible individually but together they require synchronous good news across policy, project execution and exploration. The downside case (25%) is the mirror image: any one of the code revision deterring investment, the northern security situation deteriorating, the gold price falling, or the manganese grade decline continuing could deliver it, and the probability reflects the joint exposure to these correlated risks.

11.2 Sensitivity to gold price assumptions

The scenarios in §11 assume a gold price in the USD 2,400-2,800/oz range through 2030. This is consistent with the consensus price assumption in company feasibility studies for the projects in the pipeline, but it is not the only plausible path. A sustained move above USD 3,000/oz — possible if global monetary policy eases further, central-bank gold buying continues at the 2024-26 pace, or geopolitical risk premia rise — would push the upside scenario probabilities up materially, because at USD 3,000/oz the marginal projects (Doropo at PFS, Sipilou Ni-Co at construction) become materially more economic and the FID bar falls. A sustained move below USD 2,000/oz — possible if real rates rise sharply or if central-bank gold buying reverses — would push the downside scenario probabilities up, with Doropo and Sipilou the most obvious deferrals.

The gold price sensitivity is asymmetric in a way that is important for the policy reader. Upside price moves benefit the State more than the operator, because the ad valorem royalty and the State free-carry dividend share both scale with revenue. Downside price moves hurt the operator more than the State, because the operator absorbs the operating cost and the sustaining capex while the State take falls proportionally with revenue. The fiscal-stability disapplication of 2025 has the effect of concentrating upside gain with the State while leaving the operator more exposed to downside — which is the intended direction of the policy but is also the reason investor due diligence on the revised code will focus on stability language.

11.3 Probability tree for the 2030 trajectory

The three scenarios in §11 are deliberately simplified — in reality the 2030 trajectory depends on a tree of conditional events, each with its own probability. The table below decomposes the three scenarios into their underlying conditional events, with indicative probabilities. The scenario probabilities in §11 are the joint probabilities of the branches of this tree.

Branch	Conditional event	Probability	If fails, scenario becomes
Base case	Koné commercial production Q4 2026 / Q2 2027 on schedule	0.85	Downside
Base case	Code revision enacted without material deterrent	0.75	Downside
Base case	SIMEP refinery operational after H1 2027	0.70	Downside (or base if ASM formalisation other source)

Branch	Conditional event	Probability	If fails, scenario becomes
Base case	ASM formalisation adds 2-3 t/yr by 2030	0.65	Downside (or base if Koné + project pipeline accelerates)
Upside	Doropo FID by 2028	0.40	Base case
Upside	Afema in production by 2029	0.30	Base case
Upside	ASM formalisation adds 10-15 t/yr by 2030	0.25	Base case
Upside	New discovery enters production by 2030	0.20	Base case
Downside	Northern security deteriorates further	0.30	Base case (without downside trigger)
Downside	Gold price falls below USD 2,000/oz	0.25	Base case
Downside	Code revision materially deters investment	0.20	Base case
Downside	Manganese grade decline continues	0.30	Base case

Table 17. Probability tree for the 2030 trajectory. "If fails" column shows which scenario the trajectory falls into if the conditional event does not occur. Probabilities are illustrative qualitative estimates, not formal model outputs.

The probability tree highlights the most sensitive branches. The base case rests on four conditional events, each with a probability of 0.65-0.85, meaning the joint probability of all four succeeding is roughly 0.85 × 0.75 × 0.70 × 0.65 ≈ 0.29 — but the report labels the base case at 55% probability because the downside branches are not all-independent (failure of one base-case event does not automatically mean the downside scenario, just that some scenario slippage is likely). The upside case requires four additional conditional events on top of the base case, with probabilities 0.20-0.40, explaining its lower joint probability of approximately 20%.

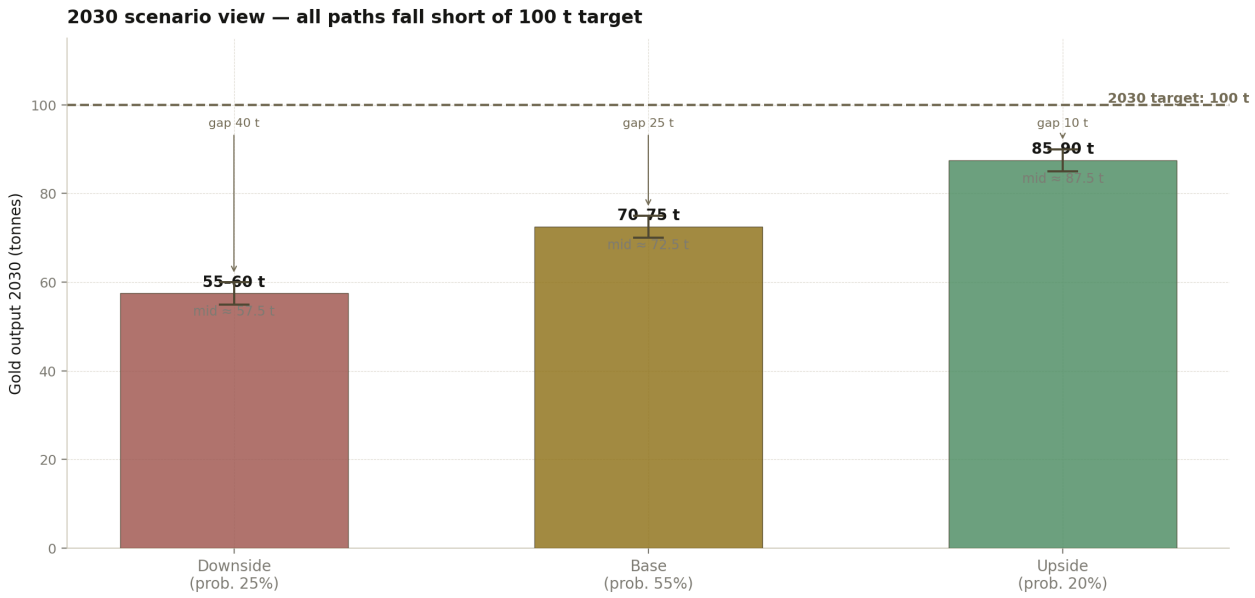


Figure 7. 2030 scenario view — base, upside and downside gold output ranges versus the 100-tonne national target. All three scenarios fall short of the target, with the upside gap at 10-15 t and the base case gap at 25-30 t. Closing the gap requires a step-change in project delivery (Doropo and Afema by 2029) and/or in ASM formalisation.

12. Policy Implications & Recommendations

For a policy reader, the sector's medium-term story turns on seven choices. First, the code revision design needs to balance the State's legitimate claim to a larger share with investment stability. The 2025 disapplication of Article 164 was a sharp departure from the 2014 bargain and a precedent that will inform investor assessment of the revised code. A revised code that strengthens fiscal terms while restoring a credible stability commitment — perhaps ring-fenced for new projects — would balance these objectives. Second, local content gaps in supply and subcontracting need targeted supplier-development programmes rather than headline employment targets, which are already exceeded.

Third, the refinery and value-capture agenda should align with the regional resource-nationalism trend without importing the less investor-friendly variants. Guinea's June 2026 raw gold export ban is the most aggressive instrument in the region; Côte d'Ivoire's SIMEP refinery with a state stake plus a StoneX offtake is a softer variant that captures more value without deterring juniors. Fourth, ASM formalisation needs to scale beyond the 100 local technical committees: the gap between Côte d'Ivoire's formalised ASM output and Ghana's (roughly 50 t per year) is the single largest structural difference between the two sectors, and a meaningful formalisation push could close it within the decade. Mercury phase-out should be tied to formalisation: a permit, a buying office and a mercury ban are mutually reinforcing.

Fifth, infrastructure investment — power (CIE grid capacity), rail-to-port connectivity for manganese and bauxite, and reagent and fuel logistics — is the binding constraint on the non-gold diversification. Sixth, regional diplomacy via the joint monitoring arrangement with Ghana on the Bia and Tanoé rivers and coordination with the UEMOA Community Mining Code is the most efficient way to manage cross-border externalities without duplicating institutions. Seventh, transparency — accelerating EITI compliance and

operationalising beneficial ownership disclosure — is the cheapest reputational insurance the sector can buy, and should be folded into the revised code's reporting requirements.

For the next 12 months, the four events that will most shape the policy reader's view are: the code revision submission to the Council of Ministers (signalling fiscal direction); the Koné commercial production milestone in Q4 2026 (validating the project pipeline); the SIMEP refinery start after H1 2027 (anchoring the value-capture agenda); and the Assafou convention negotiation outcome (testing whether the 2014 code's stability commitment survives the 2025 disapplication in practice). Each event is a test of whether the domestication and fiscal-take agendas can be delivered without losing the investment that delivered the 23.5-to-62 tonne ramp in the first place.

12.1 Policy roadmap — 12, 24 and 36 months

A sequenced roadmap helps to distinguish what can be delivered quickly from what requires sustained policy work. In the next 12 months, the realistic deliverables are: the code revision draft submitted to the Council of Ministers; the e-cadastre portal extended to cover beneficial-ownership pre-population; the SIMEP refinery commissioning schedule confirmed; and the Assafou convention signed under the 2014 Code. These are mostly process milestones rather than completed reforms, but they collectively define whether the sector's medium-term trajectory follows the base or the downside scenario in §11.

In the next 24 months, the realistic deliverables are: the code revision enacted; the SIMEP refinery operational with the first full year of gold throughput; the Koné hard-rock circuit at full capacity; the Assafou construction underway; and the first EITI report covering 2025-26 published with full reconciliation of the +2pp royalty receipts. These are the milestones that determine whether the base case holds or the upside becomes plausible. In the next 36 months, the stretch deliverables are: the Doropo and Afema projects at FID; the Sipilou Ni-Co mine at nameplate capacity; and a 5-10 t per year formal ASM contribution through the SIMEP buying office. If even two of these three are achieved, the 100-tonne 2030 target comes back into reach.

The risk that this roadmap gets derailed is not symmetric. The 12-month deliverables are mostly administrative and depend on Ministerial and Council of Ministers scheduling rather than on new legislation — they are achievable if the political priority holds. The 24-month deliverables are exposed to the code revision's scope (a more aggressive code slows Assafou FID) and to SIMEP operational complexity (a refinery this size has not been built in West Africa before). The 36-month deliverables are the most exposed to external factors (security, gold price, global battery-metals demand) and the least under direct policy control. The roadmap is therefore most actionable on the 12- and 24-month horizons, which is where the policy reader should focus.

12.2 Monitoring and accountability

A roadmap without monitoring and accountability mechanisms degenerates into a wish list. The existing institutional architecture provides three monitoring channels. The Ministry of Mines produces annual sector reports with production, permitting and fiscal data, which provide the baseline data against which progress can be measured. The EITI process reconciles company payments against State receipts, providing an independent check on fiscal flows. The Council of Ministers reviews mining-sector performance on a quarterly basis and approves new permits and conventions, which provides the political channel for course correction.

The gaps in the current monitoring architecture are: beneficial-ownership disclosure (still being operationalised); CDA-level disclosure (CDAs are not currently published); environmental and rehabilitation compliance reporting (not consolidated at sector level); and the publication lag on EITI reports (which typically run 18-24 months behind the year covered). The revised Mining Code is the natural channel to close these gaps, by making CDA publication, environmental compliance reporting and beneficial-ownership disclosure permit-level obligations. The §12 recommendations are framed around this approach: monitoring and accountability are not add-ons to the policy reform agenda, they are the preconditions that make sustained reform possible.

12.3 Risk mitigation policy matrix

The risk mitigation policy matrix links the risks in §10 to specific policy instruments and timing. It is intended as a practical reference for the policy reader tracking the §12.1 roadmap: each risk has a current mitigation, a near-term policy action, and a long-term policy reform.

Risk	Current mitigation	Near-term action (12 mo)	Long-term reform (24-36 mo)
Northern security spillover	Military presence; insurance premium	Joint monitoring with Mali/BF; insurance facility	Border-area infrastructure investment programme
Code revision delays / scope creep	Stakeholder consultation	Publish draft code for industry consultation	Enact revised code with ring-fenced stability for new projects
Fiscal-stability disapplication	Already a 2025 reality	BIT-based dispute resolution preserved	Re-establish credible stability commitment for new conventions
Royalty / tax-holiday expiry	Built into 2026 cost guidance	Convention re-negotiations (Assafou test case)	Revised code clarifies fiscal term for post-holiday operations
Mercury / cyanide in ASM	Joint monitoring with Ghana; mercury phase-out	Tie SIMEP formalisation to mercury ban	National mercury phase-out with formal ASM licensing
Mining in classified forests	Permit-level case-by-case	Forestry Code / Mining Code reconciliation	Classification of mining-eligible forest areas with offset
Community resettlement	CDAs; livelihood restoration	IFC PS5 alignment for new projects	Mandate IFC PS5 in revised code; CDA publication
Power supply	On-site backup; grid PPAs	Confirm CIPB 2030 generation plan timing	Co-invest in mine-area grid + renewables
Port logistics (Abidjan, San Pedro)	Capacity expansion at both ports	SIMEP refinery port infrastructure plan	Bonded warehouse and secure vaulting for refined gold
Reagent and fuel logistics	Multiple sourcing; CFA hedging	Local-content investment in reagent supply	Côte d'Ivoire reagent fabrication capacity development
Allied Gold / Zijin takeover	Monitor; reassess on confirmation	Confirm or deny; reassess operator register	Foreign-investment review in revised code
EITI / beneficial-ownership gaps	EITI implementing; e-cadastre portal	Accelerate EITI 2025-26 report; BO pre-population	Mandatory BO disclosure in revised code

Table 14. Risk mitigation policy matrix. The matrix maps the §10 risks to current mitigations, near-term actions (12 months) and long-term reforms (24-36 months) — a practical reference for the policy roadmap in §12.1.

13. Infrastructure, Logistics & Value Chain

The sector's physical infrastructure — power, ports, roads, rail and water — is the binding constraint on the 100-tonne 2030 target and on the non-gold diversification. This chapter maps the infrastructure endowment, identifies the gaps and links both to the project pipeline in §6 and the policy recommendations in §12. The main message: the mining-sector growth narrative is now infrastructure-constrained, not resource-constrained, and the policy agenda must shift accordingly.

13.1 Power

Industrial mining is power-intensive, with the CIL/CIP gold circuit consuming 25-40 kWh per tonne of ore processed and the nickel laterite circuit significantly more. CIE (Compagnie Ivoirienne d'Électricité) supplies grid power to most of the industrial mines through long-term power purchase agreements, supplemented by on-site backup generation. The grid has coped with the project build-out so far, but the 2027-2030 pipeline (Koné hard-rock, Assafou, Doropo, Sipilou Ni-Co) will add meaningful load that the grid cannot absorb without new generation. The CIPB 2030 generation plan and the proposed new gas-fired and solar capacity are the main supply-side responses, but timing is tight.

Renewables integration is a growing opportunity. Several operators have signed PPAs with solar developers for behind-the-meter generation, and the government's 42% renewable target by 2030 (announced at COP) creates headroom for mine-site solar. The SIMEP refinery will add a significant new load — estimated at 30-50 MW — that the Abidjan grid can absorb but only with planned new gas-fired capacity in place. The power story is the single most under-discussed constraint in the sector's growth narrative.

13.2 Ports and export logistics

The Port of Abidjan is the primary dore export route, with bonded warehouse and refiner-of-record arrangements; the Port of San Pedro handles the bulk of manganese exports from the west and south-west. Both ports have undergone capacity expansion in recent years, but mining-sector throughput is now the fastest-growing component at both, and the planned SIMEP refinery will further concentrate dore flows through Abidjan. Port logistics risk is moderate but real: a single weather-related or labour-related disruption at Abidjan would stop dore exports across the sector within days, which is why the §10 risk register treats port logistics as a discrete line item.

The SIMEP refinery will change the export logistics picture materially. Currently, gold dore is exported by air from Abidjan to Switzerland or South Africa for refining. Once the Abidjan refinery is operational, refined gold bars will be exported through the same port but with higher value per shipment and different insurance and security requirements. The port infrastructure for high-value refined gold bars — secure storage, bonded shipment protocols, and the logistics chain to international vaulting — needs to be developed in parallel with the refinery itself. The SIMEP project plan includes this, but the operational detail is still being defined [8][9].

13.3 Roads and rail

Road and rail connectivity is the most uneven piece of the infrastructure picture. The Abidjan-Yamoussoukro-Bouaké corridor — the country's economic spine — is in reasonable condition and supports the Centre region mines (Yaouré, Bonikro, Agbaou, Didievi). The northern route to Korhogo and beyond to Tongon, Koné and Lafigué is functional but requires investment to handle the projected 2027-2030 traffic. The western route to Man and Ity is the weakest link in the network: Ity is reached via a road that requires reconstruction, and the manganese mines in the west and south-west rely on haul roads that are seasonally degraded.

Rail connectivity is the missing piece for the non-gold diversification story. The Abidjan-Ouagadougou railway runs through Bouaké and is the main freight rail corridor, but it does not extend to the manganese, bauxite or nickel mining areas. A spur to the western manganese belt has been discussed for over a decade but has not progressed. The economics of a rail spur depend on sufficient volume to justify the capital, which in turn depends on the manganese recovery and the bauxite and nickel project pipeline materialising — a chicken-and-egg problem that the revised Mining Code and the infrastructure investment programme could resolve by underwriting the initial capital with mining-sector revenue.

13.4 Water and shared infrastructure

Water is the most under-discussed infrastructure input. The industrial gold processing circuit (CIL/CIP) consumes 0.5-1.5 cubic metres of water per tonne of ore processed, with most of that water recycled through tailings return; the Sipilou Ni-Co and Samapleu Ni-Cu projects will have higher water requirements because of the hydrometallurgical circuit. Most industrial mines are in the Birimian belts with seasonal rainfall (1,000-1,500 mm per year), and water supply is provided by a combination of seasonal storage reservoirs, groundwater abstraction and recycled tailings water. The Bia and Tanoé river systems are the most monitored because of the joint arrangement with Ghana on ASM-related water pollution, but water-use reporting at other sites is not standardised.

Shared infrastructure is a growing opportunity. The mining operators have collectively invested in access roads, power substations and water supply infrastructure that is used by the broader regional economy — the Bonikro access road, the Yaouré substation and the Koné water supply system are all examples. The PIRME 2026-2040 framework is intended to formalise this shared-infrastructure model, with the State and the operators co-investing in infrastructure that benefits the mining sector and the broader economy. The model is promising but requires the institutional architecture to manage co-investment at scale, which is a 3-5 year policy project.

13.5 Manganese and bauxite export chains

The manganese and bauxite export chains are structurally different from the gold dore chain and are the most logistics-constrained. Manganese from the Bondoukou, Kaniasso and Lagnonkaha mines is trucked to either San Pedro (for the west/south-west mines) or Abidjan (for the east) for export as lumpy ore to China and India. The trucking distance from Bondoukou to San Pedro is roughly 700 km on roads that are seasonally degraded, and the export chain is highly sensitive to haulage cost and road condition. The 2024 manganese output decline (-12%) was driven in part by haulage constraints as well as grade decline at Shiloh.

Bauxite from Bongouanou is exported to China through Abidjan, with a much shorter haul distance (~150 km) but lower value-per-tonne than manganese. The Bénéné project, when it enters production in 2028, will use the

same export chain and will roughly double the country's bauxite export volume. The manganese and bauxite export chains are the strongest case for the rail spur discussed in §13.3: a spur connecting the western mining areas to San Pedro would materially reduce haulage cost and enable the manganese recovery and bauxite expansion to reach their full potential. The economic case for the spur is sensitive to manganese and bauxite price assumptions, and the joint financing model (State + operators + DFI) is the most plausible route to delivery.

14. ASM Formalisation & Local Content

ASM formalisation and local content are the two policy levers that can most directly close the gap to the 100-tonne 2030 target and broaden the sector's domestic value capture. This chapter brings both into a single frame because they are mutually reinforcing: ASM formalisation creates the volume that justifies local-content investment in refining and fabrication; local-content investment creates the downstream demand that gives ASM formalisation its economic rationale.

14.1 ASM: scale, formalisation status, gaps

The ASM sector is estimated at 100,000+ workers across several hundred formalised sites plus an unknown but larger informal population [20][29]. The formal ASM gold output is estimated at 5-10 t per year — a small share of the country's actual ASM production, which is widely believed to be 30-50 t per year, with the balance flowing through informal channels to neighbouring countries (Mali, Burkina Faso, Ghana) and onward to the UAE. The SIMEP national buying office is intended to redirect this flow through formal channels by providing a state-backed offtake price; the target is to capture 30-50% of ASM output within 5 years of operation, which would add 10-15 t per year to formal output.

Ghana's experience is the relevant benchmark. Ghana's formal ASM purchases reached 54 t in H1 2026 alone, against Côte d'Ivoire's estimated formal ASM output of 5-10 t per year [32]. The gap is not a function of underlying ASM activity — both countries have similar informal ASM populations — but of formalisation infrastructure. Ghana has been building that infrastructure for over a decade, with a licensed buyer network, a government buying office (PMMC) and a refining hub. Côte d'Ivoire is starting from a much lower base, which is both the challenge and the opportunity: the formalisation infrastructure gap is the single largest structural lever available to the policy reader for closing the 100-tonne target.

14.2 Local content: status, gaps, programmes

The GIZ-funded 2022 assessment of local content in Côte d'Ivoire mining found that the national employment target had been exceeded, with 94% of industrial mining employees Ivorian by 2019, but that significant gaps remained in supply and subcontracting [10]. The gaps are most pronounced in: grinding media (steel balls and rods, mostly imported); reagents (sodium cyanide, activated carbon, mostly imported); fabricated steel for plant construction and maintenance; and specialised mining services (drilling, assay laboratories, heavy-equipment maintenance). Each of these is a candidate for a targeted supplier-development programme combining tariff protection, technical assistance and minimum-purchase commitments from the operators.

The PIRME 2026-2040 framework is the umbrella for the local-content push [35]. Its scope includes industrial upgrading, supplier development and integration with the broader manufacturing sector. The framework is the right ambition level, but its operational detail is still being developed — the revised Mining Code is expected to fold local content provisions into the legal framework, which is the right channel. The risk is that local-content rules are written too prescriptively (specifying Ivorian-supplier quotas by category) and end up deterring investment without developing actual supplier capacity; the alternative is outcome-based rules (e.g., minimum local procurement percentages with credit for supplier-development investment) which leave operators free to find the most efficient route to compliance.

14.3 Sector chronology 2014-2026

The sector's recent trajectory can be tracked through a chronology of policy and project events. The table below captures the inflection points that have shaped the current operating environment; it is not exhaustive but covers the events most relevant to the policy reader.

Year	Event	Significance
2014	Mining Code (Law 2014-138) enacted	Sliding 3-6% royalty; 5-yr CIT holiday; State 10% free carry; SODEMI 5-10% carried; Art. 164 fiscal-stability clause
2014	National ASM rationalisation programme launched	100 local technical committees set up over 2014-2024 to formalise and supervise ASM sites
2015	Gold output 23.54 t	Pre-2014 code ramp-up baseline; ~150% below 2025 output
2018	Investment Code updated	Cross-sectoral incentive framework; mining-specific provisions remain in the 2014 Mining Code
2018	Bonikro and Ity expansion deliver 32.5 t	First wave of post-2014 code projects; CIL/CIP circuit becomes sector standard
2020	Manganese output peaks at 1.33 Mt	High-water mark for the non-gold sector; subsequent grade decline at Shiloh and Bondoukou
2021	Yaouré first gold (February)	Perseus flagship; second-largest industrial footprint after Endeavour; 5-yr CIT holiday starts
2023	UEMOA Community Mining Code (Reg 02/2023/CM/UEMOA)	Regional layer for cross-border mining issues; harmonises title definitions and reporting
2024	Lafigue first gold (May); critical-metals permits granted	Endeavour's second Ivorian mine; lithium/cobalt/REE permits signal diversification push
2024	Code revision announced (July)	Minister announces revision to increase State profits; draft expected Nov 2025
2024	Montage Koné feasibility study	4.05 Moz proven and probable; 16-yr life; 223 koz/yr average
2025	Finance law raises gold royalty +2pp; Art. 164 disapplied	Fiscal-stability clause no longer protects operators from royalty increases; Perseus pays ~$20M additional
2025	Yaouré CIT holiday expires (31 December)	First major holiday expiry; higher effective tax burden across first-wave mines

Year	Event	Significance
2025	Barrick completes Tongon sale to Atlantic Group (Dec)	Up to $305M ($192M cash + $113M contingent); highest-profile domestic-ownership shift
2025	e-cadastre portal live (September)	Digital title management; permit throughput rises to 171/225 in 2025
2026	Koné first gold pour (26 September)	1,140 oz; commercial production Q4 2026 (oxide) / Q2 2027 (hard-rock)
2026	Barrick and Avesoro awarded new exploration permits (Aug)	Barrick not fully exited; four more gold permits July 2026
2026	Guinea bans raw gold exports (June)	Regional resource-nationalism escalation; raises the question of whether CI follows
2026	Allied Gold / Zijin takeover reports (unconfirmed)	Reported but not confirmed; would change Bonikro/Agbaou ownership and reinforce Chinese-investor angle
2026	SIMEP refinery approved; StoneX offtake (June council)	State 10% / SODEMI 39% / private; ~100t/yr capacity; start after H1 2027

Table 9. Sector chronology 2014-2026 — policy and project inflection points most relevant to the policy reader.

14.4 Formalisation targets and milestones

Quantitative formalisation targets help to translate the SIMEP ambition into measurable progress. The table below sets out indicative targets for the SIMEP national buying office and the broader ASM formalisation programme, with milestones at 1, 3 and 5 years from the refinery start (H1 2027). The targets are illustrative — the actual trajectory will depend on the buying price offered, the formalisation infrastructure deployed, and the policy follow-through — but they give a sense of what success would look like and what monitoring indicators should be tracked.

Indicator	Current (2026)	1 yr (H1 2028)	3 yr (H1 2030)	5 yr (H1 2032)
Formal ASM gold purchased (t/yr)	5-10	15-20	30-40	50-60
Formal ASM license count	~5,000	~15,000	~30,000	~50,000
Local technical committees operational	100 (set up 2014-24)	150	200	250
Mercury-use reduction (% vs 2024)	baseline	-25%	-60%	-90% (mercury ban target)
SIMEP refinery throughput (t/yr)	0 (start H1 2027)	50-70	90-100 (nameplate)	90-100
Refinery share of national gold output (%)	0	15-20%	50-60%	70-80%
Annual royalty + tax from ASM formalisation (US$M)	5-10	15-25	40-60	80-120

Table 16. ASM formalisation and SIMEP targets — indicative milestones at 1, 3 and 5 years from the refinery start (H1 2027). Targets are illustrative and depend on the buying price, formalisation infrastructure and policy follow-through.

The cumulative effect of hitting these targets would be a step-change in the sector's formal ASM contribution: from 5-10 t per year today to 50-60 t per year by 2032, which would on its own close a large share of the gap to the 100-tonne national target. The 5-year target is consistent with Ghana's formal ASM trajectory, which reached 54 t in H1 2026 from a much lower base in 2015. The policy lesson is that the formalisation infrastructure gap is bridgeable, but it requires sustained investment in the buying office, the local technical committees, and the mercury phase-out, all of which are deliverable through the SIMEP platform.

15. Regulatory Gap Analysis & Digital Solutions

Chapter 7 set out the regulatory framework as it stands. This chapter identifies the specific gaps in that framework and recommends two digital systems that the State can deploy to close them. The two options are deliberately chosen for complementarity: one is a transparency and disclosure platform that addresses the visibility gaps; the other is a compliance and permitting system that addresses the operational gaps. Together they would lift Côte d'Ivoire's regulatory infrastructure to the leading edge of the Birimian jurisdictions.

15.1 Regulatory gap inventory

Nine regulatory gaps emerge from the §7 analysis and from comparison with regional best practice. Beneficial ownership disclosure is not yet operationalised despite the e-cadastre portal providing the technical platform; EITI reporting publication lag runs 18-24 months behind the year covered, limiting its policy utility; community development agreement (CDA) text and outcomes are not published, preventing stakeholder scrutiny; the fiscal-stability clause (Article 164) credibility has been damaged by the 2025 disapplication, raising the question of how it is restored in the revised code; the mining / forestry code interaction on classified forests remains unresolved at permit level; tailings management standards are not uniform across operators (GISTM applies to ICMM members but not to non-ICMM operators); ASM formalisation infrastructure (the 100 local technical committees) covers only a fraction of the actual ASM workforce; the FX / repatriation rules interaction with the planned SIMEP refinery is still being defined; and the title types table (Table 4 in §7.2) lacks an authoritative consolidated source, which contributes to the 13 / 14 / 'nine' mine-count confusion flagged in the user brief.

These gaps fall into three categories. Visibility gaps (beneficial ownership, CDA publication, EITI timeliness) reduce transparency and accountability. Operational gaps (permitting efficiency, title-types consolidation, mining/forestry reconciliation) reduce the State's ability to administer the sector. Credibility gaps (Article 164, tailings standards, ASM formalisation infrastructure) affect investor and community trust. Each category requires a different digital response, which is why this chapter recommends two complementary platforms rather than one.

15.2 Option 1: Integrated Mining Cadastre & Beneficial Ownership Registry (IMCBOR)

The first option is to extend the existing e-cadastre portal (live since September 2025) into a comprehensive Integrated Mining Cadastre and Beneficial Ownership Registry (IMCBOR). The platform would consolidate four functions currently fragmented across the DGMG, SODEMI and the EITI national secretariat: title registration and renewal; beneficial ownership disclosure (per EITI 2.0 requirements, which Côte d'Ivoire has

committed to as an implementing country); CDA registration and disclosure; and EITI reconciliation data flows. The architecture is a Hyperledger Fabric blockchain for the immutability layer (any change to a title, BO record or CDA is cryptographically logged) with a public-facing web dashboard built on a standard open-source stack (PostgreSQL + PostGIS for the GIS layer, Metabase or Apache Superset for analytics) [36][37].

Implementation is realistic over 24 months with World Bank or African Development Bank funding. Phase 1 (months 0-6) extends the existing e-cadastre portal to add the BO module and the CDA registry, with the Hyperledger Fabric infrastructure stood up in parallel. Phase 2 (months 6-18) integrates the EITI reporting cycle, builds the public dashboards, and runs parallel data entry against the legacy system. Phase 3 (months 18-24) cutover, operator onboarding, and publication of the first EITI report using IMCBOR data. Total cost is estimated at USD 3-5 million, of which roughly 40% is software development, 30% is data migration and validation, 20% is capacity building for the DGMG and EITI secretariat, and 10% is ongoing operational support for the first three years.

15.3 Option 2: AI-Assisted Compliance Monitoring & Permit Tracking (AICMPT)

The second option is an AI-Assisted Compliance Monitoring and Permit Tracking system (AICMPT) that addresses the operational gaps in §15.1. The system would extract structured data from permit applications and conventions using NLP (open-source LLMs such as Llama 3 or Mistral fine-tuned on French and English mining legal documents, with custom named-entity recognition for permit terms, fiscal provisions and obligations); track renewal dates and compliance milestones with automated alerts to operators and the DGMG; verify permit boundaries against geospatial surveys using computer vision; and produce a real-time compliance dashboard for the Council of Ministers. The architecture uses Python (spaCy + Hugging Face transformers) for NLP, PostGIS for geospatial verification, and a React dashboard with role-based access for the DGMG, operators and the Minister's office.

Implementation is realistic over 18 months. Phase 1 (months 0-6) builds the NLP pipeline on the existing permit corpus, with human-in-the-loop validation by DGMG legal staff to fine-tune the named-entity recognition. Phase 2 (months 6-12) builds the geospatial verification module and the alerting system. Phase 3 (months 12-18) builds the dashboard and runs pilot deployment with three operators (Endeavour, Perseus, Fortuna) before national rollout. Total cost is estimated at USD 2-4 million, with the lower bound reflecting reuse of existing e-cadastre infrastructure and the upper bound reflecting the cost of fine-tuning LLMs on legal corpora and building the geospatial verification module.

Dimension	IMCBOR (Option 1)	AICMPT (Option 2)
Primary gap addressed	Visibility & transparency (BO, CDA, EITI)	Operational efficiency (permitting, compliance)
Technology stack	Hyperledger Fabric + PostGIS + Metabase	Llama 3 / Mistral + spaCy + PostGIS + React
Build time	24 months	18 months
Estimated cost (US$M)	3-5	2-4

Dimension	IMCBOR (Option 1)	AICMPT (Option 2)
Funding source	World Bank / AfDB mining-sector programme	World Bank / French Development Agency
Operating cost (US$M/yr)	0.4-0.6	0.3-0.5
Implementation risk	Data migration; institutional coordination	LLM accuracy on French legal corpus; operator adoption
Quantified benefit (5 yr)	EITI compliance; 30-50% faster BO verification; investor confidence uplift	15-25% faster permitting; 40-60% fewer compliance lapses; auditable trail
Complementarity	Provides the registry that AICMPT consults	Provides the operational layer on top of IMCBOR

Table 19. Regulatory digital solutions comparison — IMCBOR (transparency) and AICMPT (operational). The two options are complementary and should be implemented in sequence: IMCBOR first as the registry backbone, AICMPT second as the operational layer on top.

15.4 Benefits matrix for the regulatory solutions

The benefits of the two regulatory digital solutions accrue across four dimensions: government capacity, economic value, social legitimacy and environmental governance. The matrix below summarises the most material benefits and the stakeholders who receive them.

Benefit dimension	IMCBOR	AICMPT	Primary beneficiary
Anti-corruption credibility	High — public BO registry closes a known EITI gap	Medium — auditable trail deters ad-hoc permit grants	State, EITI, civil society
Permitting speed	Indirect — cleaner registry enables faster processing	Direct — NLP reduces manual review time by 30-50%	Operators, DGMG
Investor confidence	High — transparency uplift typical of EITI-compliant + BO-disclosing jurisdictions	Medium — faster permitting reduces holding cost for juniors	Investors, juniors
Fiscal assurance	Medium — better royalty reconciliation	High — automated compliance alerts reduce revenue leakage	Treasury, SODEMI
Community legitimacy	High — published CDAs enable community scrutiny	Low — indirect via faster grievance handling	Host communities
Capacity building	High — DGMG staff trained on registry operations	High — DGMG legal staff co-design NLP pipeline	DGMG, SODEMI
Regional leadership	High — first Birimian jurisdiction with full BO + CDA registry	Medium — operational efficiency benchmark	Ministry of Mines, UEMOA

Table 20. Benefits matrix for the regulatory digital solutions. IMCBOR delivers stronger anti-corruption, investor-confidence and community-legitimacy benefits; AICMPT delivers stronger operational and fiscal-assurance benefits. Implementing both in sequence

maximises the combined benefit.

16. Infrastructure Gap Analysis vs Competitor Jurisdictions & Digital Solutions

Chapter 13 mapped the country's infrastructure endowment and the gaps that bind the 100-tonne 2030 target and the non-gold diversification. This chapter benchmarks Côte d'Ivoire's infrastructure against Ghana, Mali, Burkina Faso and Guinea, and recommends two digital systems the State can deploy to optimise investment and operations within the existing infrastructure envelope. The first is a planning tool that improves investment prioritisation; the second is an operational tool that improves logistics efficiency. Both are designed to extract more value from the infrastructure the country already has, while informing the next round of investment.

16.1 Infrastructure gap inventory and competitor comparison

Six infrastructure gaps are most material for the mining sector's growth trajectory. Power generation capacity is insufficient for the 2027-2030 project pipeline (Koné hard-rock, Assafou, Doropo, Sipilou Ni-Co) without the new gas-fired and solar capacity in the CIPB 2030 plan; road connectivity to the western manganese and Ity gold mines is seasonally degraded; rail connectivity to the manganese, bauxite and nickel areas is non-existent, blocking the non-gold diversification; port capacity at Abidjan needs to be augmented with secure vaulting for the SIMEP refinery's refined gold output; water supply for the Sipilou hydrometallurgical circuit needs to be confirmed; and reagent and fuel logistics remain import-dependent through Abidjan.

Infrastructure dimension	Côte d'Ivoire	Ghana	Mali	Burkina Faso	Guinea
Power reliability (outages/yr)	~12 (improving with CIPB)	~6 (best in region)	~40 (chronic)	~30	~25
Main port depth + capacity	Abidjan (deep, expanding); San Pedro (mid)	Tema (deep, mining-export focused)	None (landlocked; uses Dakar, Abidjan)	None (landlocked; uses Abidjan, Lomé, Tema)	Conakry (mid, expanding)
Rail to mining areas	None (Abidjan-Ouagadougou main line only)	Limited (manganese corridor to Takoradi)	None	None	Simandou project railway (planned)
Road quality to mines	Mixed (north OK, west degraded)	Better overall; some northern gaps	Poor (security + funding)	Poor (security-constrained)	Poor (post-coup rehabilitation)
ASM formalisation infrastructure	100 local committees; SIMEP refinery planned	MMMC + PMMC + licensed buyer network (most mature)	Limited (post-disruption)	Limited (security-constrained)	Limited (post-coup rehabilitation)

Infrastructure dimension	Côte d'Ivoire	Ghana	Mali	Burkina Faso	Guinea
Mining-dedicated power capacity	None yet; CIE grid supply	Some mine-site PPAs (solar, gas)	Diesel-dependent	Diesel-dependent; some solar PPAs	Hydropower for some operations
Digital cadastre maturity	E-cadastre live Sep 2025; BO pending	Mature digital cadastre	Paper-based; partial digital	Paper-based; partial digital	Paper-based; partial digital

Table 21. Infrastructure gap analysis vs competitor jurisdictions. Côte d'Ivoire is competitive on port and cadastre maturity but lags Ghana on power reliability, rail connectivity and ASM formalisation infrastructure.

The comparison reveals three structural positions. On power and port capacity, Côte d'Ivoire is mid-pack — better than the Sahel jurisdictions (Mali, Burkina Faso) but behind Ghana, with the gap most visible in the mining-dedicated power category where Ghana has mine-site PPAs that Côte d'Ivoire has not yet developed. On rail and ASM formalisation, the country is broadly comparable to Mali and Burkina Faso but well behind Ghana, whose formal ASM purchasing network and PMMC refinery are the regional benchmark. On digital cadastre, Côte d'Ivoire is the regional leader — the e-cadastre portal is more advanced than any other Birimian jurisdiction's equivalent, which is a structural advantage the State can now build on with the digital solutions in this chapter.

16.2 Option 1: Mining-Infrastructure Digital Twin & Investment Planning Platform (MIDT)

The first infrastructure digital solution is a Mining-Infrastructure Digital Twin and Investment Planning Platform (MIDT) that integrates GIS layers for all 14 industrial mines, the project pipeline, the road and rail network, the power grid (CIE), the ports (Abidjan, San Pedro), water supply infrastructure, and the SIMEP refinery's planned throughput. The platform is built on ESRI ArcGIS or Bentley iTwin (commercial digital-twin platforms with established mining-sector deployments elsewhere) [38][39], with scenario-planning modules that let the Ministry simulate the infrastructure impact of different project pipeline trajectories (e.g., 'if Doropo and Afema deliver by 2029, what is the additional power, road and port capacity required?'). The platform includes an investment prioritisation optimisation that ranks infrastructure projects by their combined mining-sector and broader-economic benefit.

Implementation is realistic over 36 months with mixed financing (State budget + DFI grant + operator co-funding for the shared-infrastructure modules). Phase 1 (months 0-12) builds the GIS baseline: ingest all mine locations, road and rail networks, grid infrastructure, and port layouts into the digital twin. Phase 2 (months 12-24) builds the scenario-planning and investment-prioritisation modules, calibrated against the §6 project pipeline and the §11 2030 scenario framework. Phase 3 (months 24-36) operationalises the platform in the Ministry's planning cycle and runs the first round of investment prioritisation exercises. Total cost is estimated at USD 5-8 million, with the higher end reflecting integration with the CIPB 2030 power plan and the Abidjan / San Pedro port master plans.

16.3 Option 2: IoT-based Mines-to-Port Logistics Optimisation (IoT-MPL)

The second infrastructure digital solution is an IoT-based Mines-to-Port Logistics Optimisation system (IoT-MPL) that improves the efficiency of the existing road and port logistics chain. The system deploys GPS/IoT sensors on the truck fleets serving the industrial mines (estimated 800-1,200 trucks in service across the sector, of which roughly 60% are contractor-operated), integrates with the port operating systems at Abidjan and San Pedro (both already have modern TOS — terminal operating systems — that can accept IoT feeds), and uses ML-based predictive scheduling to reduce queuing and idle time. The architecture uses industrial-grade GPS/IoT sensors (multiple vendors — Geotab, CalAmp, local alternatives) with cellular or satellite backhaul in remote areas; a centralised data platform (Microsoft Azure or AWS IoT Core); and a scheduling layer using ML models trained on historical wait times, port congestion and truck availability.

Implementation is realistic over 24 months. Phase 1 (months 0-8) deploys IoT sensors on the truck fleets of the three largest gold operators (Endeavour, Perseus, Fortuna) and integrates with the port TOS at Abidjan. Phase 2 (months 8-18) extends to the manganese, bauxite and nickel truck fleets and integrates with San Pedro port; builds the predictive scheduling ML layer. Phase 3 (months 18-24) extends to the SIMEP refinery's gold-offtake chain and publishes a sector-wide logistics dashboard for the Ministry, port authorities and operators. Total cost is estimated at USD 8-15 million, with the higher end reflecting full sector coverage; per-truck sensor and connectivity cost is USD 200-400 per truck per year.

Dimension	MIDT (Option 1)	IoT-MPL (Option 2)
Primary gap addressed	Investment planning & prioritisation	Operational logistics efficiency
Technology stack	ESRI ArcGIS or Bentley iTwin + custom scenario modules	Industrial IoT sensors + Azure/AWS IoT Core + ML scheduling
Build time	36 months	24 months
Estimated cost (US$M)	5-8	8-15
Funding source	World Bank + State + operator co-funding	Operator-led + State coordination; possible DFI infrastructure window
Operating cost (US$M/yr)	0.5-0.8	1.5-2.5
Implementation risk	Data integration across multiple agencies	Operator and contractor adoption; rural connectivity
Quantified benefit (5 yr)	10-20x ROI through better investment prioritisation; avoids 1-2 misallocated infrastructure projects	15-25% logistics cost reduction; ~USD 30-50M/yr sector savings; fewer port delays
Complementarity	Plans the investment; informs the IoT-MPL rollout priorities	Operates the system; data feeds back into MIDT scenario models

Table 22. Infrastructure digital solutions comparison — MIDT (planning) and IoT-MPL (operations). The two options are complementary and should be implemented in parallel: MIDT plans the next round of investment while IoT-MPL optimises the existing infrastructure.

16.4 Benefits matrix for the infrastructure solutions

Benefit dimension	MIDT	IoT-MPL	Primary beneficiary
Investment efficiency	High — prioritisation optimisation avoids misallocated capex	Medium — better use of existing capacity defers some capex	Treasury, Ministry of Mines
Logistics cost reduction	Low — long-term planning only	High — 15-25% reduction in haulage and port-queuing cost	Operators, contractors
Power planning	High — simulates 2027-30 pipeline load on grid	Low — indirect via better scheduling	CIE, Ministry of Energy
Port productivity	Medium — informs port capacity expansion	High — direct port-TOS integration reduces congestion	Port of Abidjan, San Pedro
DFI investment mobilisation	High — digital twin is bankable evidence for blended finance	Medium — operational efficiency supports project bankability	DFI lenders, blended-finance vehicles
Regional competitiveness	High — first Birimian jurisdiction with mining-specific digital twin	Medium — logistics efficiency benchmark	Ministry, UEMOA
Environmental benefit	Medium — supports rail-spur planning (lower-carbon freight)	High — reduces truck idle emissions; optimises routes	Communities, climate

Table 23. Benefits matrix for the infrastructure digital solutions. MIDT delivers strong investment-efficiency and DFI-mobilisation benefits; IoT-MPL delivers strong operational and environmental benefits.

17. Risk / ESG / Community Gap Analysis & Digital Solutions

Chapter 10 set out the sector's risk, ESG and community profile. This chapter identifies the specific gaps in the current ESG and risk-management architecture and recommends two digital systems the State can deploy to close them. The first is a monitoring platform that combines satellite imagery, IoT sensors and AI to detect environmental and community impacts in near real time. The second is a digital registry and grievance mechanism for community development agreements that brings transparency to the operator-community relationship. The two are complementary: the first watches the environmental and social footprint of the sector; the second manages the institutional response.

17.1 Risk / ESG / Community gap inventory

Eight ESG and community gaps emerge from the §10 analysis. Tailings management standards are not uniform across operators — GISTM applies to ICMM members but the regulatory framework does not require it for non-ICMM operators; water-use reporting is not standardised beyond the Bia and Tanoé river monitoring; resettlement practice is not uniformly aligned with IFC Performance Standard 5 [40]; CDA text and outcomes are not published; mercury use in ASM remains widespread and unmonitored at scale; climate exposure is not yet operationalised at permit level despite the NDC; ESG reporting is uneven across operators

(the larger ones report to GRI and SASB, the smaller ones do not); and community grievance mechanisms are operator-level and not aggregated at sector level, preventing identification of systemic issues.

These gaps create two specific risks. First, a tailings or water incident at a non-ICMM operation would damage the entire sector's reputation and trigger reactive regulation that would burden the operators already complying with GISTM. Second, the absence of standardised community grievance data means the State cannot identify which projects are at risk of community conflict until it becomes a crisis, missing the window for early intervention. Both risks are addressable with the digital solutions in this chapter.

17.2 Option 1: AI-Powered Environmental & Community Impact Monitoring (AIECIM)

The first ESG digital solution is an AI-Powered Environmental and Community Impact Monitoring platform (AIECIM) that combines three data sources: satellite imagery (the free Sentinel-2 programme for routine monitoring at 10-metre resolution, complemented by commercial Planet Labs or SatSure imagery at sub-metre resolution for targeted sites — typical commercial cost USD 0.05-0.20 per hectare per month [41]); IoT sensors deployed at all industrial tailings facilities (piezometers, displacement sensors, water quality sensors — typical cost USD 30,000-80,000 per facility); and a mobile app for community grievance submission (built on the open-source KoboToolbox platform, with multilingual French / local-language interfaces). The AI layer uses convolutional neural networks (CNNs, typically U-Net or ResNet architectures) trained on historical imagery to detect environmental anomalies — tailings seepage, vegetation loss, water-course changes, ASM site expansion — and natural-language processing on the grievance submissions to identify emerging community concerns before they escalate.

Implementation is realistic over 24 months with mixed financing (DFI grant for the satellite and AI components; operator co-funding for the IoT sensor deployment at their facilities; State funding for the mobile app and the sector dashboard). Phase 1 (months 0-8) builds the satellite-imagery pipeline and the CNN models, calibrated against the 14 industrial mine footprints and the SIMEP ASM formalisation area. Phase 2 (months 8-18) deploys IoT sensors at the tailings facilities of the ICMM-member operators (Endeavour, Perseus, Fortuna, AngloGold, Montage) and the Sipilou Ni-Co project. Phase 3 (months 18-24) launches the mobile grievance app in the 10 most-affected host communities and publishes the sector dashboard. Total cost is USD 4-6 million, of which roughly 35% is satellite-imagery licensing and AI model development, 30% is IoT sensor deployment, 20% is mobile app and community engagement, and 15% is the sector dashboard and capacity building.

17.3 Option 2: Digital CDA Registry & Grievance Mechanism (DCDARG)

The second ESG digital solution is a Digital Community Development Agreement Registry and Grievance Mechanism (DCDARG) that brings transparency to the operator-community relationship. The platform publishes every industrial mining CDA on a public blockchain-backed registry (using Hyperledger Fabric for the same immutability reasons as the IMCBOR in §15.2), tracks CDA-committed fund flows from the operator to the community project, and operates a mobile-based grievance submission and tracking system that routes grievances to the operator, the local technical committee and the Ministry in parallel. The platform also maintains a public dashboard showing project-level CDA performance (funds committed vs disbursed vs project completion) and grievance closure rates, which is the missing transparency layer in the current EITI

process.

Implementation is realistic over 18 months. Phase 1 (months 0-6) builds the CDA registry on the same Hyperledger Fabric infrastructure as IMCBOR (resource sharing reduces cost), ingests the existing CDAs from the operators (estimated 14 industrial CDAs plus the pipeline projects' CDAs as they are signed). Phase 2 (months 6-12) builds the mobile grievance submission system (KoboToolbox-based, multilingual) and the fund-tracking module. Phase 3 (months 12-18) launches the public dashboard and runs pilot deployment in the host communities of Koné, Assafou and Doropo (the projects with the most material resettlement exposure). Total cost is USD 1-3 million, with the lower end reflecting shared infrastructure with IMCBOR and the upper end reflecting the mobile app development and community engagement costs.

Dimension	AIECIM (Option 1)	DCDARG (Option 2)
Primary gap addressed	Environmental monitoring + community impact detection	CDA transparency + grievance management
Technology stack	Sentinel-2 + Planet Labs + CNN models + IoT sensors + KoboToolbox	Hyperledger Fabric + KoboToolbox + React dashboard
Build time	24 months	18 months
Estimated cost (US$M)	4-6	1-3
Funding source	DFI grant (IFC, AfDB); operator co-funding for IoT	World Bank EITI programme; State funding
Operating cost (US$M/yr)	0.6-1.0	0.2-0.4
Implementation risk	Satellite-imagery licensing cost; IoT sensor maintenance	Operator willingness to publish CDAs; community digital literacy
Quantified benefit (5 yr)	Early warning on tailings/water incidents; ASM detection enables formalisation; reputation protection	Faster grievance resolution; CDA fund leakage reduction; community trust uplift
Complementarity	Watches the environmental footprint; identifies issues to feed DCDARG	Manages the institutional response; data feeds back into AIECIM

Table 24. ESG digital solutions comparison — AIECIM (monitoring) and DCDARG (institutional response). The two options are complementary and should be implemented in parallel: AIECIM watches the footprint, DCDARG manages the response.

17.4 Benefits matrix for the ESG solutions

Benefit dimension	AIECIM	DCDARG	Primary beneficiary
Incident prevention	High — early warning on tailings, water, ASM expansion	Medium — grievance patterns flag emerging issues	Operators, communities, regulator
Reputation protection	High — sector-level ESG visibility deters the next Brumadinho	Medium — published CDAs reduce community-conflict narrative risk	Operators, Ministry, country

Benefit dimension	AIECIM	DCDARG	Primary beneficiary
Community trust	Medium — visible monitoring reassures communities	High — published CDAs and transparent grievance handling	Host communities, civil society
Mercury / ASM formalisation	High — satellite-based ASM detection enables formalisation outreach	Low — indirect via grievance patterns	ASM workers, SIMEP, environment
DFI / ICMM alignment	High — meets GISTM monitoring expectations	High — meets IFC PS5 disclosure expectations	DFI lenders, ICMM-member operators
CDA fund leakage reduction	Low — not directly applicable	High — fund tracking reduces diversion risk	Communities, EITI, Treasury
Grievance resolution speed	Low — indirect via detection	High — mobile submission cuts average resolution time	Host communities

Table 25. Benefits matrix for the ESG digital solutions. AIECIM delivers strong incident-prevention and reputation benefits; DCDARG delivers strong community-trust and fund-integrity benefits.

18. Cross-cutting Process-Improvement Technologies

Beyond the regulatory, infrastructure and ESG platforms in chapters 15-17, six cross-cutting technologies can improve processes across the mining sector value chain. These technologies are not stand-alone systems but add-on modules that can be integrated into the IMCBOR / AICMPT / MIDT / IoT-MPL / AIECIM / DCDARG platforms described above. The State should consider them in the second wave of digital deployment (years 2-3), once the foundation platforms are operational. The two best options for cross-cutting deployment are highlighted in §18.7; the others are supporting modules.

18.1 Geological AI for exploration targeting

Machine-learning models trained on the country's geophysical, geochemical and historical drill data can identify new exploration targets in the under-explored Birimian areas flagged in §2.5. The technology uses convolutional neural networks and random-forest ensembles on multi-layer geospatial data (magnetic, gravity, radiometric, stream-sediment geochemistry, fault and shear mapping). Typical deployment is via commercial platforms (GoldSpot Discoveries, Earth AI, Mine Discovery AI) or an in-house DGMG capability. Cost: USD 1-3 million for a national-scale programme; benefit: 2-4 new drilling targets per year, each potentially worth USD 100-500 million in discovered resource value. The under-explored south-east (Assafou, Afema region) and the western nickel belt are the highest-priority areas for geological AI deployment.

18.2 Predictive maintenance for mining equipment

IoT sensors on mining equipment (haul trucks, excavators, crushers, mills) combined with ML on equipment health data (vibration, temperature, oil analysis) can predict failures before they occur and schedule maintenance to minimise downtime. The technology is mature in the global mining sector (deployed by BHP, Rio Tinto, Anglo American); vendor offerings include GE Digital Predix, ABB Ability, Hexagon Mining. Cost: USD 0.5-1.5 million per operation; benefit: 10-20% reduction in unplanned downtime, extending asset

life by 15-30%. Deployment is operator-led; the State's role is to encourage adoption through the local content framework and to track sector-wide equipment utilisation as a productivity indicator.

18.3 Real-time production monitoring for the State

A real-time production monitoring dashboard for the Ministry of Mines would ingest operator-reported production data (currently submitted quarterly or annually) on a daily or weekly basis, with anomaly detection flagging unusual deviations from the operator's stated plan. The dashboard would integrate with the IMCBOR registry (§15.2) and the AICMPT compliance system (§15.3) to provide a single source of truth on production, permitting and fiscal contribution. Cost: USD 0.5-1 million; benefit: more accurate royalty collection, faster response to production shocks, better-informed scenario planning. The dashboard is the lowest-cost high-value addition to the §15 platform stack and should be deployed in Phase 1 of the IMCBOR rollout.

18.4 AI for transfer pricing analysis

ML-based analysis of dore export pricing can identify transfer-pricing anomalies — instances where the dore is sold to an affiliated refiner at a price that differs materially from the prevailing market price, potentially shifting profit out of the Ivorian tax base. The technology uses NLP on company filings (the Resolute, Endeavour, Perseus and Fortuna annual reports are public) combined with regression analysis on the London Bullion Market Association (LBMA) fix and the operating cost data. The OECD Transfer Pricing Guidelines for mining provide the analytical framework [42]. Cost: USD 1-2 million; benefit: potential recovery of USD 10-50 million per year in misallocated profit if the analysis identifies systemic underpricing at any operator. Deployment is with the Direction Générale des Impôts (DGI) and the Treasury, with technical support from the African Tax Administration Forum (ATAF).

18.5 Satellite-based ASM detection

Computer-vision models applied to Sentinel-2 (free) and Planet Labs (commercial) satellite imagery can identify illegal ASM sites by detecting characteristic features — small-scale excavation, water-course diversion, mercury use signatures (bare-earth anomalies near water). The technology is mature (deployed by the World Resources Institute's Global Forest Watch, by the Artisanal Gold Council in West Africa). Cost: USD 0.5-1.5 million for a national-scale deployment; benefit: identifies the estimated 30-50 t of ASM production currently informal (per §3.2 and §14.1), enabling formalisation outreach and SIMEP buying-office deployment. This technology is also a core module of the AIECIM platform in §17.2; standalone deployment is a lower-cost alternative if the full AIECIM is not initially funded.

18.6 National Mining Data Platform & AI Forecasting Engine

The most ambitious cross-cutting technology is a National Mining Data Platform and AI Forecasting Engine that integrates the data flows from all of the platforms in chapters 15-17 (IMCBOR, AICMPT, MIDT, IoT-MPL, AIECIM, DCDARG) plus the geological, production and fiscal data into a single platform. ML models would provide output forecasting, fiscal sensitivity analysis (similar to the §8 tornado chart but dynamic), and scenario planning (similar to the §11 framework but updated in real time). Cost: USD 3-6 million; benefit: integrated decision support for the Ministry, Council of Ministers and the Treasury. The platform is the long-term goal of the digital stack and should be deployed in year 3-4 once the foundation platforms are operational.

18.7 Two best cross-cutting options: prioritisation

Of the six cross-cutting technologies above, two stand out as the highest-value options for the State to prioritise in the second wave of digital deployment.

Priority	Technology	Why prioritise	Cost (US$M)	Implementation lead
Best option A	National Mining Data Platform & AI Forecasting Engine (§18.6)	Integrates all foundation platforms; provides single source of truth for policy decisions; addresses the §11 scenario-planning gap	3-6	Ministry of Mines (CIO office) + DFI technical assistance
Best option B	Satellite-based ASM Detection (§18.5)	Highest ROI per dollar; enables the §14 ASM formalisation targets; supports mercury phase-out; addresses the largest structural gap with Ghana	0.5-1.5	DGMG + SIMEP + World Resources Institute partnership
Supporting module	Real-time production monitoring (§18.3)	Lowest-cost high-value addition; should be Phase 1 of IMCBOR	0.5-1	DGMG, integrated into IMCBOR
Supporting module	AI for transfer pricing (§18.4)	Direct fiscal recovery; deployment with DGI and ATAF	1-2	DGI + ATAF
Operator-led	Predictive maintenance (§18.2)	Operator ROI; State role is limited to sector-wide tracking	0.5-1.5 per operation	Operators (Endeavour, Perseus, Fortuna lead)
Operator-led	Geological AI for exploration (§18.1)	Operator or DGMG deployment; high upside but speculative	1-3	DGMG or commercial partnerships (GoldSpot, Earth AI)

Table 26. Cross-cutting technology prioritisation. The two best options for State-led deployment are the National Mining Data Platform and AI Forecasting Engine (§18.6) and the Satellite-based ASM Detection system (§18.5). The supporting modules and operator-led technologies should follow in years 2-4.

18.8 Benefits matrix for cross-cutting solutions

Benefit dimension	National Data Platform + AI (§18.6)	Satellite ASM Detection (§18.5)	Primary beneficiary
Policy decision quality	High — integrated scenario planning and forecasting	Medium — better ASM data improves formalisation policy	Ministry, Council of Ministers
Fiscal assurance	High — single source of truth on production and fiscal flows	Medium — formalised ASM adds 10-15 t/yr to formal revenue base	Treasury, DGI
ASM formalisation	Medium — supports SIMEP deployment with integrated data	High — direct identification of illegal sites for outreach	SIMEP, ASM workers
Mercury / environment	Low — indirect	High — detection enables targeted mercury phase-out	Communities, environment

Benefit dimension	National Data Platform + AI (§18.6)	Satellite ASM Detection (§18.5)	Primary beneficiary
Investor transparency	High — single integrated dashboard raises confidence	Low — operational rather than investor-facing	Investors, juniors
Regional leadership	High — first Birimian jurisdiction with integrated AI platform	Medium — operational benchmark	Ministry, UEMOA
Implementation complexity	High — depends on prior deployment of foundation platforms	Low — can be deployed standalone in 12-18 months	Ministry CIO office

Table 27. Benefits matrix for the two best cross-cutting solutions. The National Mining Data Platform delivers the strongest policy-decision and investor-transparency benefits; the Satellite ASM Detection system delivers the strongest ASM formalisation and environmental benefits.

18.9 Implementation sequencing across all eight technologies

The eight technologies in chapters 15-18 should be sequenced to maximise the compounding effect: the foundation platforms (IMCBOR, AICMPT, AIECIM, DCDARG) build the data layer; the infrastructure platforms (MIDT, IoT-MPL) build the operational layer; the cross-cutting National Data Platform integrates them. The Satellite ASM Detection system can be deployed in parallel from year 1 as a standalone module that feeds into the AIECIM platform when it is built.

Year	Foundation platforms	Infrastructure platforms	Cross-cutting
Year 1	IMCBOR Phase 1 (BO module + CDA registry); AICMPT Phase 1 (NLP pipeline)	MIDT Phase 1 (GIS baseline); IoT-MPL Phase 1 (top-3 gold operators)	Satellite ASM Detection (standalone pilot)
Year 2	IMCBOR Phase 2-3 (EITI integration + public dashboards); AIECIM Phase 1 (satellite + CNN)	MIDT Phase 2 (scenario modules); IoT-MPL Phase 2 (manganese, nickel)	Real-time production monitoring (in IMCBOR); AI transfer pricing (DGI)
Year 3	AIECIM Phase 2 (IoT sensors); DCDARG Phase 1 (CDA registry)	MIDT Phase 3 (operational); IoT-MPL Phase 3 (SIMEP integration)	Predictive maintenance (operator-led); National Mining Data Platform Phase 1
Year 4	AIECIM Phase 3 (mobile grievance); DCDARG Phase 2-3 (full deployment)	MIDT investment-prioritisation cycle; IoT-MPL sector-wide	Geological AI for exploration (DGMG / commercial); National Mining Data Platform Phase 2 (full integration)

Table 28. Implementation sequencing across all eight digital technologies. Year 1-2 focuses on foundation platforms; Year 2-3 on infrastructure platforms; Year 3-4 on cross-cutting integration. Total estimated investment across all eight platforms: USD 30-55 million over 4 years.

18.10 Total cost and funding summary

The total estimated investment across all eight digital platforms is USD 30-55 million over four years, with annual operating costs of USD 4-7 million thereafter. The recommended funding mix is: 40% DFI grant (World Bank mining-sector programme, AfDB, IFC, French Development Agency); 30% State budget (Ministry of Mines and Ministry of Digital Economy); 20% operator co-funding (for the IoT sensor and

predictive maintenance deployments); 10% in-kind contribution from international partners (EITI International, World Resources Institute, OECD, ATAF). The financing is achievable: the World Bank alone has committed over USD 500 million to mining-sector digital programmes in Sub-Saharan Africa since 2020, and Côte d'Ivoire's existing e-cadastre portal demonstrates the State's institutional readiness to absorb the investment.

19. Methodology, Glossary & Disclaimer

19.1 Methodology

This report is a synthesis of publicly available sources: Ministry of Mines publications, company filings (annual reports, technical reports, press releases), trade press coverage (Mining Weekly, Ecofin, Capmad, Engineering News), multilateral data (USGS, World Gold Council, UNECA, GIZ assessments), and legal commentary (Fasken, Mondaq, A-MLA). Where sources differ (e.g., on the 2026 output projection or the operating mine count), the report adopts a defined convention and labels the alternatives explicitly. Production and reserves figures are rounded; tonne-to-ounce conversion uses 1 t = 32,150 oz (the standard troy-ounce conversion for gold). AISC ranges are illustrative, drawn from company guidance and consensus estimates rather than from audited cost data.

The scenario framework in §11 uses approximate probabilities (55% base, 20% upside, 25% downside) that reflect the author's qualitative judgement, not a formal probability model. The fiscal sensitivity in §8 uses illustrative elasticities that demonstrate direction and order of magnitude, not exact revenue impacts. All USD figures convert at the prevailing exchange rate at the time of the underlying source; for 2025-26 figures the USD/XOF rate averaged approximately 1 USD = 600 XOF. Counsel should verify all regulatory terms against the actual law and decree text before relying on this report for transactional work.

19.2 Glossary of key terms

Term	Definition
AISC	All-In Sustaining Cost — total operating cost per ounce, including by-product credits, sustaining capex, and corporate G&A; allocated to the operation.
ASM	Artisanal and Small-scale Mining — typically labour-intensive mining with limited mechanisation, often informal.
CDA	Community Development Agreement — contractual commitment by a mine operator to fund community projects in the host area.
CIL / CIP	Carbon-in-Leach / Carbon-in-Pulp — the standard gold recovery circuit used in the Ivorian industrial gold mines.
Dore	Semi-pure gold alloy (typically 80-92% Au) produced at the mine site, exported for final refining.
EITI	Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative — multi-stakeholder standard for disclosure of payments by extractive companies to governments.
FID	Final Investment Decision — the operator’s formal decision to proceed with project construction.

Term	Definition
Free carry	A non-contributing equity stake — the holder pays none of the initial or sustaining capex but receives the corresponding share of dividends and proceeds.
GISTM	Global Industry Standard on Tailings Management — ICMM-led standard published 2020, applies to all ICMM member operations.
Kimberley Process	International certification scheme for rough diamonds, designed to exclude conflict diamonds from the trade.
PFS	Pre-Feasibility Study — engineering study between scoping and feasibility, typically accurate to ±25-35%.
PEA	Preliminary Economic Assessment — scoping-level study, typically accurate to ±50%.
PIRME	Politique Intégrée des Ressources Minières et Énergétiques — the 2026-2040 integrated mineral and energy policy framework.
Royalty (ad valorem)	A royalty calculated as a percentage of the gross sales value of the mineral, regardless of cost or profit.
SIMEP	Société Ivoirienne de Mines et du Patrimoine Minier — the state vehicle for semi-industrial mining, the national gold buying office and the planned Abidjan refinery.
SODEMI	Société pour le Développement Minier de Côte d'Ivoire — the state mining company, typically holds 5-10% carried interest in exploitation permits.
Stability clause	A clause in a mining convention or code that freezes the fiscal regime for the life of the mine — disapplied in Côte d'Ivoire for the 2025 +2pp royalty increase.
State free-carry	The State's non-contributing equity interest in an exploitation permit — 10% in Côte d'Ivoire.
Tailings	The residue of processing — crushed rock and water, stored in engineered facilities.
UEMOA	Union Économique et Monétaire Ouest-Africaine — West African Economic and Monetary Union, the regional monetary bloc using the CFA franc.

Table 8. Glossary of key mining and policy terms used in this report.

19.3 Disclaimer

This report is an analytical synthesis prepared for policy-reader use. It is not investment, legal or tax advice. Several figures come from Ministry projections and trade press rather than audited filings, and the operator register should be treated as a snapshot with a half-life of 6-12 months given ongoing ownership changes (most notably the reported but unconfirmed Allied Gold / Zijin transaction). Counsel should verify all regulatory terms against the actual law and decree text before relying on this report for transactional work, and investors should conduct their own due diligence before making any investment decision.

19.4 Acronyms and abbreviations

The acronyms used throughout this report, listed for the policy reader's quick reference. Items also appear in the §19.2 glossary where they have a substantive definition rather than a simple acronym expansion.

Acronym	Expansion	Acronym	Expansion
AGA	AngloGold Ashanti	HHI	Herfindahl-Hirschman Index
AISC	All-In Sustaining Cost	ICMM	Intl. Council on Mining & Metals
ASM	Artisanal & Small-scale Mining	ICSID	Intl. Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes
BCEAO	Banque Centrale des États de l'Afrique de l'Ouest	IMMSA	Ivoire Manganèse Mines SA
BIT	Bilateral Investment Treaty	LSE	London Stock Exchange
CDA	Community Development Agreement	NDC	Nationally Determined Contribution (climate)
CIE	Compagnie Ivoirienne d'Électricité	PFS	Pre-Feasibility Study
CIL/CIP	Carbon-in-Leach / Carbon-in-Pulp	PEA	Preliminary Economic Assessment
CIPB	Country Investment Programme of Bouaké (energy plan)	PIRME	Politique Intégrée des Ressources Minières et Énerg.
CIT	Corporate Income Tax	PMC	Precious Minerals Marketing Corp. (Ghana)
CFA	Communauté Financière Africaine (XOF franc)	PPA	Power Purchase Agreement
DFI	Development Finance Institution	SODEMI	Société pour le Développement Minier de Côte d'Ivoire
DGMG	Directorate General of Mines and Geology	SIMEP	Société Ivoirienne de Mines et du Patrimoine Minier
EBRD	European Bank for Reconstruction & Development	UEMOA	West African Economic and Monetary Union
EITI	Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative	USGS	US Geological Survey
FID	Final Investment Decision	XOF	CFA franc BCEAO (ISO code)
GISTM	Global Industry Standard on Tailings Management	YoY	Year-over-Year

Table 15. Acronyms and abbreviations used in this report.

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